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BENGALURU - CHENNAI - COIMBATORE - HUBBALLI - HYDERABAD - KOCHI - KOLKATA - MADURAI - MALAPPURAM - MANGALURU - MUMBAI - NOIDA - THIRUVANANTHAPURAM - TIRUCHIRAPALLI - VIJAYAWADA - VISAKHAPATNAM

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OFS switch erodes ₹95,000 crore of investor wealth

AFTER EFFECT. Over 60% of fully offer-for-sale issues in the last five years are now trading below their listing-day price

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
Kumar Shankar Roy
bl, research bureau

“By shamelessly merchandising birdless bushes, promoters have in recent years moved billions of dollars from the pockets of the public to their own purses...” Warren Buffett wrote those lines in his annual letter to Berkshire Hathaway shareholders amid the 2001 dot-com saga.

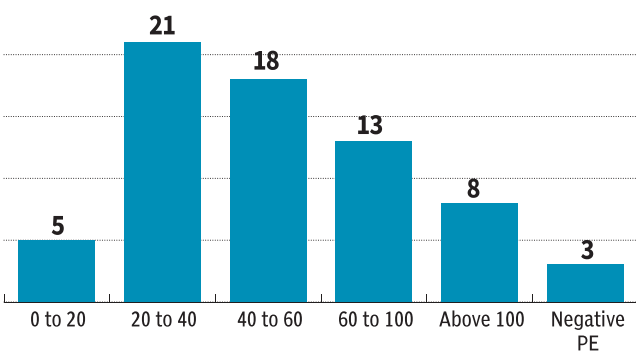
He could almost have been describing a large part of India's IPO market over the last five calendar years (2021-2026) when price-to-earnings multiples above 100x became common, reflecting an insatiable appetite for new issues, with share sellers laughing all their way to the bank.

In theory, capitalism is presented as a system in which public markets help growing businesses raise fresh capital, expand and create wealth that is shared between founders and new investors. In practice, a surprising number of Indian IPOs have resembled something far less noble. They became a sophisticated wealth-transfer mechanism in which retail investors, armed with ₹15,000 applications and dreams of multi-baggers in the long run, handed over hard cash so that promoters, private equity

P to P transfer: Public to Promoter

IPO valuations split by PE bands*

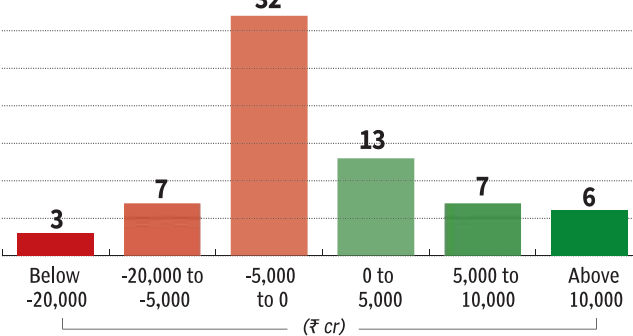
No. of IPOs



Note: 68 IPOs launched over the past five years that were entirely offer-for-sale (OFS) issues are considered. *The PE ratio is derived by using the listing-day market capitalisation of each issue and the PAT of the most recent financial year preceding the IPO; **Difference between listing-day market cap and current market cap (as of April 2, 2026) Source: Capitalline.com

How much market-cap changed from listing to present**

No. of IPOs



funds and early backers could walk away with real money, leaving investors holding shares that have since sunk in the market downturn.

COSTLY WAVE

The biggest clue lies in the structure of these issues itself. Over the last five years, India saw around 300 IPOs that had an Offer-for-Sale (OFS) component. Tellingly, 68 of these were fully OFS issues. This means not a single rupee of the ₹1.76 lakh crore raised went into expanding capacities, funding growth, redu-

cing debt or building a business. The only cold objective was monetisation.

Today, the numbers are not flattering. These 68 fully OFS IPOs debuted with a combined market capitalisation of about ₹16.88 lakh crore on listing day (closing). By April 2, that figure had fallen to roughly ₹15.93 lakh crore, a destruction of around ₹95,000 crore of wealth. Here, one should not just look at the number, but also the time value of money since many years have passed for some of these IPOs and also the opportunity cost had

they invested it elsewhere including a simple bank FD.

On average, each such company has seen about ₹1,400 crore wiped out from its listing-day value. More importantly, over 61 per cent, or 42 of the 68, are now trading below their listing-day market capitalisation. The listing-day pop, the euphoric anchor-book headlines and the breathless television count-downs proved to be short-lived excitement rather than enduring value.

This is perhaps the clearest evidence that many of these is-

suers were sold at rich valuations. The average P/E of these 68 companies was 57x even though Nifty50 in the last 5 years has traded in the 20-30x band. In IPO of firms such as Vedant Fashions, C.E. Info Systems, and Campus Activewear, valuations exceeded 100x PE — meaning investors paid over ₹100 for every ₹1 of profit.

WIPEOUT

Among the more striking cases is AGS Transact Technologies where the current market capitalisation is lower than the funds

raised by selling shareholders through OFS! The ongoing market correction has begun to expose such IPO excesses. Expensive stories are being repriced. Businesses with weak fundamentals and no real runway are falling hardest.

Yet, this is not a case for avoiding IPOs with 100 per cent OFS altogether. OFS issues including by Mankind Pharma, Anand Rath Wealth, ICICI Prudential AMC and KFin Technologies are examples of strong businesses that listed at reasonable valuations.

Selling shares via the OFS route at expensive valuations, by itself, is not a crime. Promoters and financial investors have every right to sell. But investors should ask a simple question: If the promoters, private equity funds and early backers are all choosing this moment to cash out, why should the public be rushing to buy in?

There are lessons in all of this. Investment bankers did what they are paid to do — maximise price and their fees. As Buffett said in the 2001 letter, fee-hungry investment bankers acted as eager postmen for such deals. Promoters and financial backers did what they are supposed to do — sell when valuations are generous. The only group that forgot to do its job was the investor.

Govt to increase gas supply to fertilizer units, industries to 90% from tomorrow

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas said on Saturday it will increase natural gas supplies to fertilizer manufacturing units and commercial and industrial consumers to 90 per cent, effective Monday.

For piped natural gas (PNG), the government has prioritised 100 per cent supply to domestic PNG and CNG (transport). Supplies to industrial and commercial consumers connected to the grid are currently at 80 per cent of their average consumption.

“Supply to operating urea plants is now steady at 70-75 per cent of their last six-month average consumption. Considering the available in-

ventory and expected LNG cargo arrivals, overall gas supply available to fertilizer plants will be increased to approximately 90 per cent of their average consumption over the preceding six months, effective April 6, 2026,” the Ministry said.

Additionally, gas supply to other industrial and commercial sectors, including through CGD networks, will be enhanced by a further 10 per cent from April 6, it added.

All industrial consumers, including fertilizer plants, have been advised to indicate additional spot requirements so that gas marketing companies can arrange supplies accordingly.

LPG SUPPLY STABLE

The Ministry emphasised that, despite LPG imports be-

The move aims to stabilise production amid global supply disruptions linked to geopolitical tensions

ing affected by the prevailing geopolitical situation, there has been no reported dry-out at distributorships.

To improve access for migrant labourers, LPG distributors will sell 5-kg free trade LPG (FTL) cylinders on presentation of valid ID proof, without requiring address proof. Since March 23, around 5.7 lakh such cylinders have been sold.

Further, a three-member Executive Directors’ Committee, in consultation with

State authorities and industry bodies, is finalising a plan for the sale of commercial LPG in States/UTs. A total of 72,047 tonnes of commercial LPG have been sold since March 14.

FRESH UREA TENDER

Separately, Indian Potash Ltd has invited bids to supply 15 lakh tonnes of granular/prilled urea at the West Coast and 1 lakh tonnes at the East Coast, for vessel sailings by June 14, 2026. The last date for bid submission is April 15, with validity until April 23.

This is the first fertilizer procurement tender following the recent escalation in West Asia on February 28, and also the first in the current financial year. Earlier, Rashtriya Chemicals and Fertilisers had floated a tender in mid-February 2026.

7 years on, India resumes energy trade with Iran

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Petroleum Ministry said on Saturday that Indian refiners have sourced crude oil from Iran, marking the first such purchase after May 2019.

The development comes after the US unsanctioned Iranian crude oil as the intensifying West Asian conflict prolonging the closure of the Strait of Hormuz has choked 20 per cent of the global supplies.

Refuting news reports and social media posts on an Iranian crude cargo diverted from Vadinar to China due to payment issues, the Ministry reiterated that India's crude oil requirements remain fully secured for the coming months.

Details p12

GLOBAL CONFLICT, LOCAL IMPACT



SUPPLY CHAIN SHOCK. People queue up with empty LPG cylinders to buy a refill amid supply disruptions linked to the ongoing West Asia conflict, in Mumbai on Saturday. The government has been urging citizens to avoid panic buying, saying fuel supplies remain adequate despite disruptions linked to the closure of the Strait of Hormuz. p11

Venu Srinivasan resigns as trustee of Bai Hirabai Jamsetji Tata Navsari Charitable Institution

Our Bureau
Mumbai

Tata Trusts trustee Venu Srinivasan is understood to have resigned from the Bai Hirabai Jamsetji Tata Navsari Charitable Institution, one of the smaller trusts in the Tata Trusts fold, citing other business commitments, according to sources.

MISTRY'S CHALLENGE

His resignation comes on the heels of a former trustee, Mehli Mistry, challenging the appointment of Venu Srinivasan and Vijay Singh to the board of the charitable institution, on the grounds that they do not satisfy the criteria laid out in the trust deed.

According to sources, Mistry made a formal complaint with the Maharashtra



Venu Srinivasan, Chairman Emeritus of TVS Motor

Charity Commissioner on Friday, saying that the trust deed mandates specific conditions, including adherence to the Parsi Zoroastrian faith and Mumbai residency requirement.

Mistry contended that both Srinivasan and Singh fall short on these counts and therefore should be considered disqualified under the governing provisions.

There was no response till press time to messages sent

to Srinivasan and Mistry to confirm the details. Srinivasan, Chairman Emeritus of TVS Motor Company, sits on the board of seven trusts of the Tata group.

Mistry also sought an inquiry by the Charity Commissioner into the matter and sought directions for all trustees to submit affidavits affirming their eligibility.

The Bai Hirabai Jamsetji Tata Navsari Charitable Institution, established in 1923, is part of the wider Tata Trusts network and plays a role in supporting community welfare initiatives, particularly among Parsis.

It has the same board of trustees as that of Sir Ratan Tata Trust. Other trustees on the board include Tata Trusts Chairman Noel Tata, Vijay Singh, Jimmy Tata, Jehangir HC Jehangir, and Darius Khambata.

ISING TENSIONS

Srinivasan's resignation adds a new layer to the ongoing governance-related frictions within the Tata Trusts, where differences among trustees have surfaced since the death of Ratan Tata in October 2024.

Last year, Srinivasan had been among the three trustees, along with Noel Tata and Vijay Singh, who had rejected Mistry's reappointment as a life trustee.

Prior to that, Mistry had spearheaded an opposition to the reappointment of Vijay Singh as a Tata Trusts nominee on the Tata Sons board.

Earlier this year, Pramit Jhaveri, who had aligned himself with Mistry, had said he did not wish to be considered for reappointment as a trustee on the board of Sir Dorabji Tata Trust.

Suresh P Iyengar
Mumbai

Notwithstanding the raging West Asia war and its impact on the stock market, retail investors remain enthusiastic on equity investments though with a cautious approach.

The average daily turnover (ADT) in the cash equity market segment on the NSE and the BSE hit a 19-month high in March, the highest in FY26 as investors used every sharp dips to average their investments.

Benchmark indices Sensex and Nifty had tumbled 10 per cent last month, registering their worst performance since the Covid pandemic. The crash was driven by rising geopolitical tensions, surging oil prices and intense FPI

selling. The ADT in the cash market on the NSE jumped 10 per cent in March to ₹1.25 lakh crore from ₹1.14 lakh crore in February. On the BSE, the cash segment ADT increased 8 per cent to ₹9,375 crore from ₹8,692 crore in February.

In absolute terms, the cash market turnover was a tad lower in March at ₹23.78 lakh crore compared with ₹24.08 lakh crore in the previous month as the number of trading days last month was lower at 19 versus 21 in February.

MIXED TRENDS

In FY26, the ADT in the equity cash segment on the NSE dropped 6 per cent to ₹12.68 lakh crore from ₹13.56 lakh crore in FY25 amid unprecedented volatility. In the same period, the BSE recorded a 3 per

cent increase in ADT at ₹95,671 crore (₹93,200 crore).

Shweta Rajani, Mutual Fund Head, Anand Rath Wealth, said the rise in ADT has more to do with heightened volatility when market activity tends to increase as investors realign their portfolios and reassess risk exposure.

Despite volatility, there are expectations that SIP inflows in March will also remain consistently positive in equity MFs, she said.

The retail investor approach seems more balanced, with reduced direct equity exposure and a preference for staggered investing through diversified equity mutual funds, added Rajani.

Hariprasad K, Research Analyst and Founder, Livelong Wealth, said that on every dip, retail in-

vestors are selectively stepping in where they see value, though risks persist, particularly in the small-cap space where their participation remains elevated.

The upcoming large IPOs such as Jio's and the NSE's could attract new investors into the market and bring in incremental liquidity, especially from first-time participants looking for quality, well-known businesses.

Ponmudi R, CEO, Enrich Money, said that with over 25 crore demat accounts, the retail base is structurally strong, but about 4-5 crore investors are consistently participating in delivery-based investing.

In an environment where corporate earnings visibility is uncertain due to global headwinds, retail investors are active but not fully committed, he said.

bl.interview

Hari Viswanath
bl. research bureau

The war in the Gulf is a battle for the markets too, as high crude oil prices and supply disruptions have turned the tables upside down. But unfortunate as it may be, this isn't the only battle markets are fighting. Even prior to the start of the war, there were concerns due to AI disruption, a slowing US economy and an elephant in the room called US private credit. The recent tremors in US private credit, in the view of some market veterans, are somewhat reminiscent of what happened in the early part of 2007. Needless to say, when credit markets shake, equity markets tremble. Indian markets, too, bore the brunt of the global financial crisis. So, should investors here worry? Are the concerns exaggerated or justified?

To get answers, *bl.portfolio* caught up with Ramki Muthukrishnan, Managing Director at S&P Global Ratings, to decode what is happening in US private credit and what risks investors must watch out for. *Edited excerpts:*

We have been hearing a lot about private credit for the last six or seven months. It first made headlines when Tricolour Holdings and First Brands defaulted in September 2025. Now, we are hearing extreme views—some experts from the US say this is 2007-08 credit crisis redux, while others say they are incomparable. So, for us in India to understand what is happening, can you begin by simplifying to us what exactly is private credit in the US financial system?

Sure. Put simply, private credit is any type of lending where a bank is completely disintermediated. It is non-bank lending to private entities—that is what it was in its primary form: direct lending. Of course, today, it has become larger, little more complex and involved. You have a whole lot of various funds or vehicles that are available to investors who can access the asset class, but in its primary form, direct lending was the primary strategy for private credit.

Other strategies in private credit include credit opportunity funds, distressed lending, infrastructure real estate, but direct lending in the form of a bilateral agreement or just club lending with a few other private credit lenders was really the primary form of private credit.

It certainly has grown significantly over the last 15 years. I think post Global Financial Crisis (GFC), the size of private credit was about \$200-250 billion. Today, the estimates are that it is north of \$2.5 trillion. Now, the challenge with private credit is it is an opaque market and hence difficult to size precisely.

So, the banks are not part of this lending, but although they retracted from making direct loans to leveraged middle-market companies, banks did not exit the ecosystem of direct lending altogether. Instead, banks lend to private credit lenders.

What exactly has driven this massive growth from \$250 billion to over \$2.5 trillion? There are several things that have driven the growth. First, it's the change in the regulatory environment with the reforms that were promulgated after the GFC, such as leveraged lending inter-agency guidelines. Those guidelines were a deterrent for banks from lending directly to leveraged middle-market companies. As banks vacated from this spot, lenders like asset managers moved in setting up funds to lend to the senior part of the capital structure.

The second driver was just the low rate of interest following the

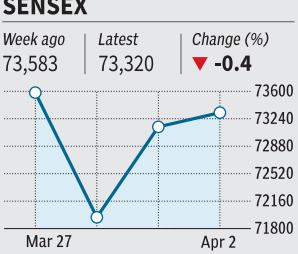
The investors going in understand there is a 5 per cent limitation on withdrawal. And so this is really not gating. The manager cannot liquidate illiquid assets at a substantial haircut to the detriment of the other investors

WISE WORDS.

“ Making any investment decision right now is very difficult given the markets are literally trading headlines

STEVE EISMAN
one of the 'Big Short' investors, on investing amid war-driven uncertainty

MARKET ACTION.



‘While credit headwinds will exist, there is no systemic risk at this point’

THEIR VIEW. Ramki Muthukrishnan of S&P Ratings dissects the mechanics of the over \$2.5-trillion US private credit industry and explains why the credit markets are not heading for a 2007-08 redux

GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO



● **PROFILE**

Ramki Muthukrishnan is a Managing Director and heads the Non-Banking Finance team at S&P Ratings, with oversight on ratings from sub-sectors, including Business Development Companies, Asset Managers, Operating lease companies, consumer and commercial lending. He also leads research and outreach in Credit Estimates and Private Credit on the analytical side. He has close to 25 years of experience in corporate, CLOs and RMBS ratings

in the US to the private credit lenders?

On exposure they have, it is tough to get a sense of how much banks have lent to private credit, but banks lend to what is called non-banking financial institutions (NBFIs).

A portion of NBFI is the private credit part. Bank loans to NBFIs have increased over the years. The Federal Deposit Insurance Corporation (FDIC)-insured banks reported about \$1.4 trillion in loans in 2025. This is about 11 per cent of their total loans. Based on S&P research, this is up from about \$700 billion in 2020. From 2020 to 2025, they grew at a CAGR of about 14 per cent, in some ways mirroring the growth of the private credit industry.

Can you explain the business model of these companies? What are spreads they charge? How much do they leverage? We hear about terminologies like listed and unlisted BDCs. What are they?

At its core, what private credit does is lend to the middle-market companies, most of which are held by private equity firms. The lending could be through vehicles set up in an asset manager's fund complex. An asset manager has a whole fund complex. It could be through a GP-LP fund, or you could take leverage and lend through a middle-market CLO or collateralised loan obligation (pooled private loans to mid-sized firms) or a BDC (Business Development Company).

I'll spend some time on BDCs because they're very much in the news. They were created by the Small Business Investment Act in 1980. The intent was to provide capital to small- and middle-market entities. This required BDCs to invest or lend about 70 per cent of their capital in private companies or in small public companies with less than \$250-million market cap. Now, because these are registered investment companies, they're required to distribute 90 per cent of their income to shareholders. BDCs are not taxed, which adds an attractive element to it.

Originally, BDCs needed to have a leverage of 1:1 debt-to-equity. In 2018, that was relaxed to 2:1, if they needed to. So, if they have \$100 in equity, they could have \$200 in debt. Now, there are three types of BDCs:

Publicly-traded BDCs: These are like regular stocks; you can go to an exchange and buy them. They are the most liquid.

Perpetual non-traded BDCs: These are in the news lately. They are not traded in the market, but you have the ability to redeem every quarter, typically with a cap of 5 per cent of your Net Asset Value (NAV).

Private non-traded BDCs: These are more like a drawdown fund, where your liquidity is limited. They have longer lock-in periods, typically a five-seven-year life. The loans structured in direct lending space, typically, pay 450-500 basis points above the secured overnight funding rate (SOFR). So, for example, if the SOFR is at 5 per cent, they get 9.5-10.5 per cent income on their loans and the returns go up if the vehicle is leveraged. After you meet funding costs, income can be in the high single-digit to low double-digit

the asset the vehicle holds.

The investors going in understand there is a 5 per cent limitation on withdrawal. And so, this is really not gating. The manager cannot liquidate illiquid assets at a substantial haircut to the detriment of the other investors. Our analysis shows there is sufficient headroom either in the form of unencumbered collateral that can be pledged to raise added liquidity, level-2 assets or liquid loans that can be monetised even if there are redemption needs of 5 per cent in the next few quarters.

The industry is also facing criticism due to factors like PIK or 'payment in kind' and different asset managers marking the same loans at different price levels.

It is important to differentiate between loans that are structured with the option to PIK and loans that were originally cash pay but experienced liquidity and performance issues at the entity level and convert to PIK.

First, let's address PIK loans structured via amendments. The rise in SOFR benchmark rates (as Fed increased interest rates) in 2023 and 2024 led to increase in financing costs, putting pressure on the company's ability to generate sufficient cashflow.

Lenders provided relief via amendments to agreements, allowing issuers to defer their interest payments and address their liquidity challenges. These are viewed as a default by S&P, as there is a breach in terms of payment. This is what the industry calls problem PIKs.

Then there are loans structured with an option to PIK from day one. These are not necessarily problematic, but more an optionality that the loan structure has. The option for lenders to PIK their interest from day one is driven by strategic choices. These loan structures provide financial flexibility and are negotiated with issuers at the time of the financing.

With regard to different asset managers marking the same loan at different levels, the assets in the direct lending space are level-3 assets, which are marked to model. The inputs to model are not standardised and slight change in judgment around inputs can lead to different valuation levels. However, pricing is generally range bound.

You could have a difference if there is information asymmetry; this happens when as lead lenders have more ongoing communication with sponsors and reflect more updated information in their valuation than other group of lenders.

There could be a difference in valuation when there are differences in timing and frequency of valuation too.

Just when the 17-year credit cycle that started from the ashes of the global financial crisis started to unwind, the Gulf War 3 has complicated things even more and it looks like Fed rate hike is more likely than a cut. How does your perspective change on private credit in this context? Credit is credit, whether it is public or private. To me, the biggest challenge for private credit or BSL loans today is the exposure it has

to software. Private equity and private credit both like software because of the predictability of cash flows. It was seen as non-cyclical.

However, the risk of AI disruption is real. In our view, this risk is nuanced. If you are an enterprise resource provider deeply embedded in a company's workflow, the option of "ripping and replacing" doesn't really work. Those companies have less of a risk. But for software companies providing services like recruitment/talent management, multimedia strategy, translation services or business intelligence, they are more at risk of being disrupted by AI.

One good thing is that for the loans private credit has made to software companies, they have an LTV (Loan-to-Value) of 30-35 per cent. That means there is sizeable equity of 65 per cent sitting under the 35 per cent loans. Even if the enterprise value shrinks by 50 per cent, the loans are still above water; although in such a case, the LTV might jump from 30 per cent to about 60-70 per cent. The lender will need to figure out options then.

Can you explain how you assess these companies in private credit?

Our credit view on direct lending comes through what we call credit estimates. Credit estimate by S&P is not a credit rating. But it is still a credit opinion on unrated companies that have loans, which collateralise middle-market CLOs that we rate. We use the same methodology, we use the same information requirement and form our insights on their financials, business, growth etc. The only difference is that we don't have access to management because these are done at the behest of a CLO manager and not issuer.

So, credit estimates are provided to the CLO managers (which could be a BDC). Now, the CLO managers are the same GPs or asset managers that manage other vehicles in their fund complex.

And like I said, when they underwrite a company, they allocate portions of the loans across various vehicles. So, we have 3,500 credit estimates currently.

And if you aggregate the size of the debt of the companies to whom they have lent, that is about \$800-850 billion out of the direct lending component within private credit, which has a size of, say, over a trillion dollars. So, we have a fairly big footprint.

Out of this \$800 billion of lending that you have a view on, how much is lent to the software sector, which is where fears are spiking in terms of default risks?

Of the 3,500 or so companies we have, I would say over 430, 440 are software companies. In terms of value, it will be around \$150-175

billion or 20 per cent of the universe.

What are the default rates in the private credit industry now?

Different institutions have different default rates given the methodology used to calculate them. Based on the performance of credit estimates, our calculation of default rate on a trailing 12-month basis is 4.45 per cent. We include both traditional defaults like bankruptcy, missed payments, equitisation of debt as well as soft defaults.

For 2025, the biggest drivers of credit estimate defaults have been cash-pay loans that convert to PIK, which accounted for 68 per cent of the total defaults, followed by issuers requesting for maturity extensions (extending loan maturities) without providing adequate and offsetting compensation to investors.

These default rates are higher than S&P calculation of trailing 12-month default rates for speculative grade bonds/loans in the US public market, which was under 4 per cent.

There are macro headwinds with the geopolitical tensions, potential pickup in inflation and rates staying elevated for longer. Then there is the structural transformation that some portion of software industry is going through with the threat of AI disruption.

That said, the companies came to 2026 from a position of strength; based on our review of credit estimates in 2025, revenue and EBITDA went up in 74 per cent and 65 per cent of the cases, while median revenue and EBITDA went up 14 per cent and 26 per cent respectively compared to the ones done in 2024.

Many listed BDCs are trading at discount to NAVs. Are they reflecting concerns that default rates can spike?

There are many factors that contribute to difference between price and valuation. Professor Damodaran cites reasons like mood and momentum, liquidity and trading ease, incremental information and group think as drivers of price. The current negative sentiment around private credit and macro views also influence price. Then there is the AI threat, which is real but nuanced and hard to quantify and that uncertainty is also priced by the market.

Finally, can you explain why you are of the view that this is not 2008 crisis redux?

In direct lending, loans are extended to companies with business and growth trajectories having already demonstrated revenue and cash flows.

The GPs diligence these entities before underwriting them. They hold them in the funds they manage through the duration of the loan; essentially, the funds are buy and hold investors. These entities have financial audits and further, companies in the core and lower middle market also have financial maintenance covenants in their credit agreement as a sign of early warning. The funding is also well diversified across sectors and industries in most of the vehicles GPs manage.

The 2007-08 crisis, on the other hand, was due to loans to one asset class — residential home loans. The loans were to borrowers, many of whom would not have qualified but possibly did so in anticipation of rising home prices, which would imply an increase in home equity to justify the loans. Further, these loans were originated and sold to be securitised and re-securitised; the incentives were not aligned creating a bit of an agency issue.

Bank lending to private credit is limited, and banks are also sufficiently over-collateralised. Our view is that while credit headwinds exist, we do not see evidence of a broader spillage of this into financial system to trigger a systemic risk now.

Post Global Financial Crisis, the size of private credit was about \$200-250 billion. Today, the estimates are that it is north of \$2.5 trillion. Now, the challenge with private credit is it is an opaque market and hence difficult to size precisely

Aarati Krishnan

After 18 months of going nowhere, Indian stock indices have tumbled another 14-15 per cent in the last two months on US-Iran hostilities. The Nifty50 PE (price-earnings multiple) is now below its 10-year average, while several stocks have corrected 40-50 per cent from highs. All this may nudge you to bargain-hunt for stocks. Here are five factors to keep in mind while you bottom-fish.

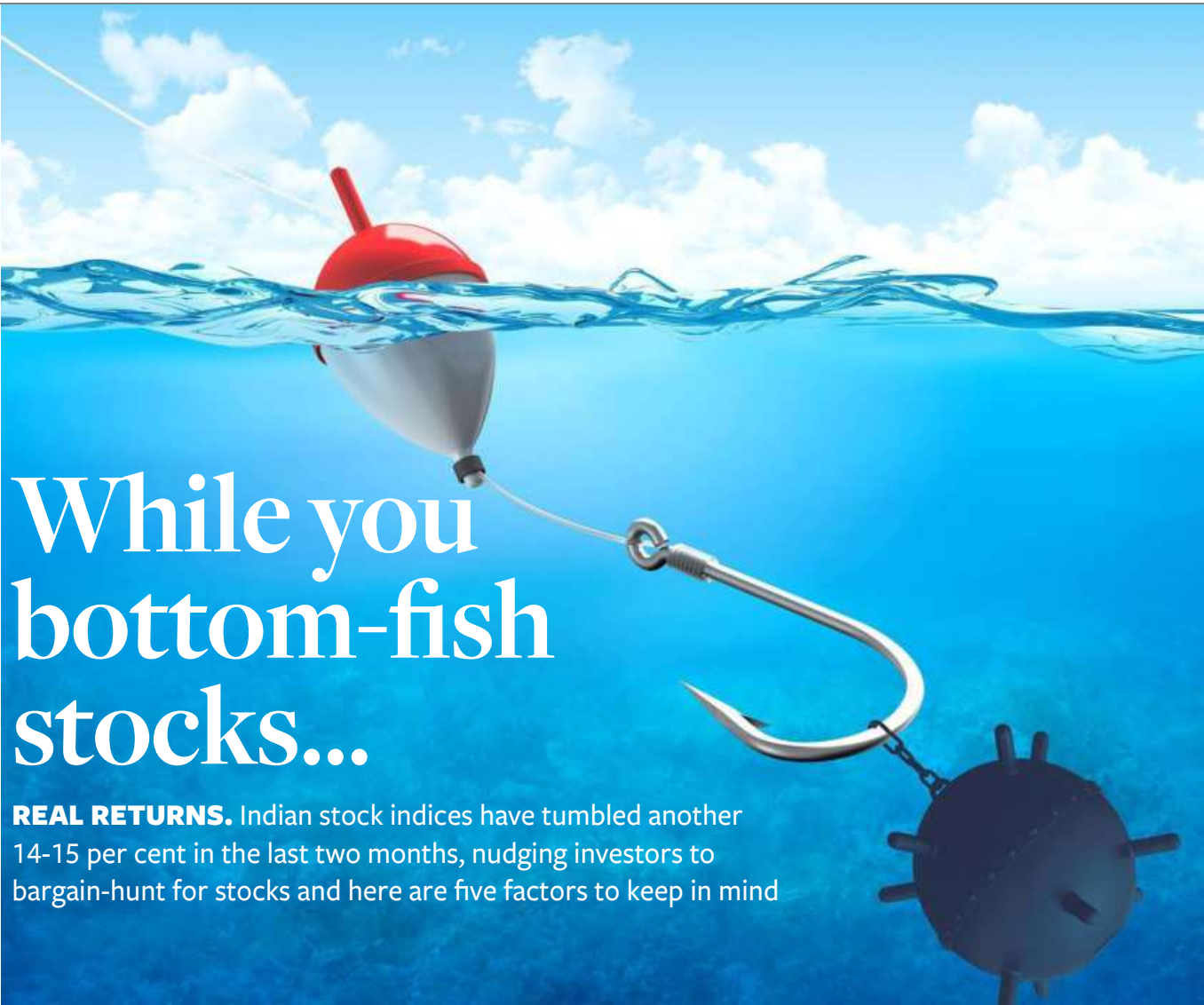
STRUCTURAL RESET

It is in the nature of stock markets to over-react. But when a bull phase ends and a bear phase unfolds, it is usually because corporate or economic fundamentals are being reset in some way. Understanding what is being reset is important to making the right choices when looking to bottom-fish.

Today, three structural changes are underway, which are likely to impact Indian companies. One, even if Trump concludes his Iran misadventure, it appears unlikely that the supply shock to crude oil and its derivatives will recede for several months. As West Asia may remain conflict-ridden, the oil market may continue to factor in a higher geopolitical risk premium than before the war. This will likely elevate input costs for all sectors which are net users of petroleum or its downstream products. This calls for sticking to companies and sectors which have wide margins and pricing power to pass on input cost spikes, while giving a wide berth to companies with thin margins that are at the mercy of buyers.

Two, returning inflation from elevated crude oil and commodity prices will likely force the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) to switch from rate cuts to rate hikes over the next year. Returning inflation could, in fact, be a global theme which prevents central banks from employing their time-tested tool of cutting rates to prop up asset prices. Higher interest rates make an automatic case for lower equity valuations. In the post-Covid world, Indian investors have gotten quite used to paying pricey multiples for growth stocks. They need to flip this mindset now and look for growth that comes with modest valuation.

Three, while AI-disruption fears have faded into the background after the recent spike in energy costs, AI adoption appears to be here to stay and will likely benefit some sectors while upends others. The identity of the winners and losers remains up in the air. Understand



GETTY IMAGES/ISTOCKPHOTO

While you bottom-fish stocks...

REAL RETURNS. Indian stock indices have tumbled another 14-15 per cent in the last two months, nudging investors to bargain-hunt for stocks and here are five factors to keep in mind

whether a sector or company is a net gainer or loser from AI, before swooping in on it.

DON'T CHASE SMALL-/MICRO-CAPS

When markets bottom out after a sharp fall, small-cap and mid-cap stocks usually suffer more brutal reverses than large-caps. They also slip into a valuation discount to large-caps.

This happens for three reasons. One, when external risks such as raw material price spikes, interest rate hikes or adverse exchange rate moves trigger a downturn, small-sized and mid-tier companies in a sector take a sharper earnings hit than their larger peers. Two, small-cap stocks are owned more by retail investors than by institutions. The former can panic more when corrective phases arrive. Three, in any correction, small-cap stocks fall more than their fundamentals warrant because they bear the brunt of vanishing liquidity on top of uncertain prospects.

This trend is yet to play out in the current market fall. During the Covid crash of February 2020, the Nifty50 fell about 30 per cent in a month's time, while the Nifty Midcap 150 index plunged 33 per cent and the Nifty Smallcap 250 index

MIND IT

- Avoid bottom-fishing in small and micro caps
- Don't buy merely because a stock has crashed
- Stagger your entry; don't deploy all at once

crashed about 40 per cent. At the bottom of the 2020 bear market, the Nifty50 and Midcap 150 index traded at a PE of about 18 times. The Nifty Smallcap 250 saw its price-to-book dwindle to just 1 time (its PE was distorted by loss-making companies).

In the ongoing correction from September 2024, the Nifty50 and Nifty Midcap 150 are down about 15 per cent from highs, while the Nifty Smallcap 250 index is down 21 per cent. However, the Nifty50 PE is below 20, while the Midcap 150 index (31 PE) and Smallcap 250 (27 PE and price to book of over 3 times) trade at a stiff premium to the Nifty50.

This suggests that the bottoming out process may not be over yet for these segments of the market. If you're looking to bottom-fish today, stick to large

companies and sector leaders rather than small-caps and also-rans, because there may be more pain in the offing.

SKIP WHAT FELL THE MOST

When you're betting on a market rebound, temptation is strong to bet on stocks that (you think) will help you recoup losses in double-quick time. Many investors believe that what fell the most will rise the most. This is a sure way to decimate your wealth.

When markets revive after a structural reset, the leaders of the new bull market are often completely different from those in the previous one. After the 2008 capex bust, infrastructure, real estate and capex stocks were the biggest losers falling 70-80 per cent. They took several years to get back to their original prices, while IT and pharma stocks led the new bull phase. After the Covid crash, pharma and IT stocks sank into oblivion while auto, consumption and hospitality led the rally.

It is quite difficult at this stage to spot the sector leaders of the next bull market. But the post-Covid rally suggests that caution is warranted on discretionary consumption, auto, hospitality and realty, which were

big gainers of the 'unlock' theme.

Stay clear of sectors or themes that have tanked much more sharply than the indices since September 2024. Bargain-hunt in sectors which have underperformed for the last five years.

DON'T GO ALL IN

Given all the above uncertainties, if you're raising cash to invest in equities, don't go all in at once.

Usually, new bull markets take shape only after investors swing from optimism to despondency to outright panic. While optimism about the India story has certainly turned to gloom over the past year, a few market indicators are yet to signal a capitulation phase. Valuations of small- and mid-cap stocks remain elevated. India VIX remains at moderate 25 levels, compared to 70-80 during the previous panic phases.

This makes it hard to predict when the corrective phase will end, and the next recovery will take shape. Different sectors are also likely to bottom at different times. Don't deploy all your cash at once. Hold some dry powder to participate in future falls.

The author is a Contributing Editor

Travel cover amid war disruptions

Venkatasubramanian K
bl. research bureau

Sometimes, the best-laid plans can go haywire due to circumstances or situations that are completely outside our control and beyond our thinking.

The war in West Asia is one such event that is disrupting businesses around the world; the airline travel segment, especially, quite harshly.

The month of March saw flight cancellations aplenty. Over 5,500 flights were cancelled during the month.

April is a month of holiday travel for a lot of Indians, given that schools and colleges tend to have scheduled vacations.

Many also opt to travel to international destinations. As many as 3.27 crore Indians travelled abroad in 2025 alone, according to data from the Ministry of Tourism.

With no end to the war in sight, overseas travel plans may have to be worked upon smartly, and being a bit more prepared becomes very important for various situations.

Travel insurance is critical and compulsory when travelling to most developed nations and even for many emerging economies.

In the current war situation, it is important to know what your travel insurance will cover and what it would exclude. Additionally, you must be aware of the likely premiums you may have to incur for buying the cover.

ONLY FOR NORMAL TIMES

Broadly, travel insurance covers five different types of emergencies for those flying abroad.

These include loss of baggage, loss of passport, trip cancellation, medical expenses and personal accident. Loss of baggage



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TAKE NOTE

Wars and other such events are expressly excluded in most insurance policies

ailments while travelling abroad. Such claims are typically honoured, subject to policy conditions.

However, the scenario changes if claims arise due to war.

If trip and flight cancellations are directly attributable to the war – drones attacking airports, bombs hurled, runways closed due to conflicts etc. – then the travel insurance typically will not cover any of the claims. Wars and other such events are expressly excluded in most insurance policies.

In such cases, the airline company may be your only recourse for rescheduling, refunds and so on.

Even stays at hotels due to war disruptions would have to be arranged by traveller or the airline when they are stranded

in a conflict zone.

Similarly, medical expenses directly attributable to a war – situations such as getting hit by shrapnel, hurt by debris from a blast, injuries sustained as collateral damage in conflict-related attacks and so on – would have to be dealt at the government level or any medical help you can get.

Insurers would not cover medical expenses arising due to war-related accidents or events.

There are workarounds to avoid conflict zones in your air travel. Currently, popular tourist locations such as Japan, China, Thailand, Australia, New Zealand, Singapore, Malaysia, Vietnam, Indonesia, Hong Kong and so on have flights uninterrupted.

Even for travel to the West Coast locations in the US (and perhaps from there to other locations), there are flights from Hong Kong.

Some international airlines are also looking to avoid West Asia and land at locations such as Munich for taking travellers to Europe and beyond.

Travellers to West Asian

countries, however, may have to take calls based on how the situation evolves.

PREMIUMS TO PAY

Several insurers including Tata AIG, ICICI Lombard, HDFC Ergo, Digit, Bajaj General, Zurich Kotak, Niva Bupa and National Insurance, among a few others, offer travel insurance.

Loss of baggage and passport are covered for amounts as indicated earlier.

Medical expenses are typically covered under policies of-fering \$250,000-500,000 coverage. Personal accidents are covered in the range of \$20,000-30,000.

A travel insurance policy for a family of four with parents in their 40s and two teenage kids would cost ₹6,500-10,000 for a Schengen trip.

The travel insurance cover would cost ₹10,000-24,000 for a US trip.

Insurers typically offer 24X7 claim support. Usually, their apps can be used to lodge claims or through secure links shared via WhatsApp.

Interest rates on home loans (%)

Institution	Loan amount		
	Under ₹30 lakh	₹30 to 75 lakh	Over ₹75 lakh
BANKS (Floating rates)			
Axis Bank	8.0-9.10	8.0-9.10	8.0-9.10
Bank of Baroda	7.20-8.95	7.20-8.95	7.20-8.95
Bank of India	7.10-10	7.10-10	7.10-10
Bank of Maharashtra	7.10-9.65	7.10-9.65	7.10-9.65
Canara Bank	7.15-10	7.10-10	7.05-9.90
Central Bank	7.10-8.70	7.10-8.70	7.10-8.70
DBS Bank	<=8.70	<=8.70	<=8.70
Dhanlaxmi Bank	8.20-12.0	8.20-12.0	8.20-12.0
Federal Bank	7.30-9.50	7.30-9.50	7.30-9.50
HDFC Bank	7.75-13.20	7.75-13.20	7.75-13.20
ICICI Bank	>=7.45	>=7.45	>=7.45
Indian Bank	7.15-8.55	7.15-8.55	7.15-8.55
IOB	7.10-8.20	7.10-8.20	7.10-8.20
IDBI Bank	7.35-11.95	7.35-11.95	7.35-11.95
J&K Bank	>= 7.25	>= 7.25	>= 7.25
Karnataka Bank	7.31-11.69	7.31-11.69	7.31-11.69
Karur Vysya Bank	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65	8.50-10.65
Kotak Mahindra Bank	>=7.70	>=7.70	>=7.70
Punjab National Bank	7.25-9.0	7.20-9.0	7.20-9.0
Punjab & Sind Bank	7.30-10.70	7.30-10.70	7.30-10.70
RBL Bank	>= 9.0	>= 9.0	>= 9.0
State Bank of India	7.25-8.45	7.25-8.45	7.25-8.45
South Indian Bank	>=7.20	>=7.20	>=7.20
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	7.90-9.30	7.90-9.30	7.90-9.30
BANKS (Fixed rates)			
Bank of Baroda	8.90-9.95	8.90-9.95	8.90-9.95
Canara Bank	8.50-10.75	8.50-10.75	8.50-10.75
ICICI Bank	8.65-11.80	8.65-11.80	8.65-11.80
HOUSING FINANCE COMPANIES (Floating rates)			
Tata Capital	>=7.50	>=7.50	>=7.50
PNB Housing	7.75-10.05	7.60-10.05	7.50-9.95
Central Bank Housing	10-12.85	10-12.85	10-12.35
Samman Capital	>=8.75	>=8.75	>=8.75
Aditya Birla Housing Fin	>=7.75	>=7.75	>=7.75
Bajaj Finserv	7.15-20	7.15-20	7.15-20
GIC Housing Finance	>=8.80	>=8.80	>=8.80
Sundaram Home Finance*	>=10.65	>=10.65	>=10.65
Piramal Finance Limited	>=9.99	>=9.99	>=9.99
IIFL Home Finance	>=8.75	>=8.75	>=8.75
LIC Housing Finance	7.15-9.65	7.15-9.75	7.15-10.10
HOUSING FINANCE COMPANIES (Fixed rates)			
LIC Housing Finance	10-10.25	10-10.25	10-10.25

Rates that vary with tenures or credit score within the specified loan amounts are indicated as a range. Fixed interest rates may be subject to a revision after a specified tenure. Rates may also apply only for a definite period and change to floating thereafter. Data taken from respective bank's website as on Apr 03,2026. Contributed by BankBazaar.com. *Annual percentage rate;

ALERTS.

NHB launches Gruh Sugam portal

National Housing Bank (NHB), the apex agency established by the government to promote a cost-effective housing finance system, has launched the Gruh Sugam Portal. The portal enables defence/government personnel to avail home loans with ease from the location of their posting. This portal will accelerate digital lending adoption and financial inclusion. Defence personnel, members of paramilitary forces, government employees (State and Central) can apply for housing loans digitally through their respective administrative units, and there is no need to visit the banks and financial institutions for loan approvals and processing.



SIP for global funds

Vested has introduced systematic investment plans (SIPs) for Global Funds on its platform, allowing investors to invest fixed amounts at regular intervals instead of placing manual orders. The Global Funds offering, launched in December 2025, provides access to strategies managed by global asset managers such as Fidelity, Franklin Templeton, Morgan Stanley and JPMorgan.

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Even as investors eagerly seek an end to the ongoing conflict in West Asia, there are no signs of a thaw as yet, with the US President's recent address to his nation adding to the anxiety of the already beleaguered Indian equity markets.

Furthermore, there is no clarity on when the Strait of Hormuz would be opened for regular goods traffic shipments without disruptions. The sharp rise in crude prices has brought fiscal calculations of the government under the scanner. LPG cylinder prices have already been raised. Any disruption or shortage due to the war may lead to higher inflation and a possibility of higher interest rates as well, later in the year.

From a market perspective, alongside mid and small-caps, large-cap stocks (perceived as resilient in volatile phases) too continue to face the heat.

Given their importance to most investor portfolios, underperforming large-cap funds can hamper financial goals and would require careful decision-making in investment choices.

Many large-cap funds have struggled to get past the Nifty 100 TRI or BSE 100 TRI on a consistent basis.

UTI Large Cap (UTI Master Share), which is in its 40th year, has seen returns turn lukewarm for years now, going below many peers and standard benchmarks.

Investors can exit the fund and also stop any SIPs in the scheme and move to better-performing schemes.

SLACKENING RETURNS

UTI Large Cap's track record over the past several years has been underwhelming, with the fund's performance trailing standard benchmarks and peers.

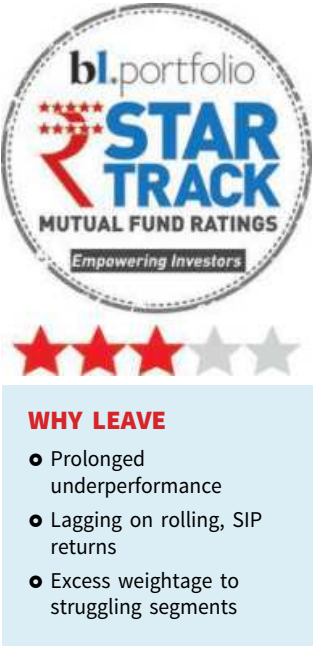
Across one, three, five and 10-year timeframes, the fund has underperformed the Nifty 100 TRI by 1-2.5 percentage points. The fund's underperformance with respect to the BSE 100 TRI is also similar.

UTI Large Cap's five-year point-to-point returns are moderate, at 9.4 per cent. In this timeframe, the Nifty 100 TRI gave 10.1 per cent and the BSE 100 TRI delivered 11 per cent. Even on a 10-year basis the fund lags these benchmarks.

When five-year rolling returns are considered from January 2013 to March 2026, the fund has outperformed the Nifty 100 TRI a mere 36.2 per cent of the time. The mean return for the fund in this rolling period is 13.7 per cent, while for the Nifty 100 TRI it is 13.9 per cent. When returns on monthly SIPs (XIRR) over the past 10 years are considered, the UTI Large Cap fund has delivered

Exit the laggard

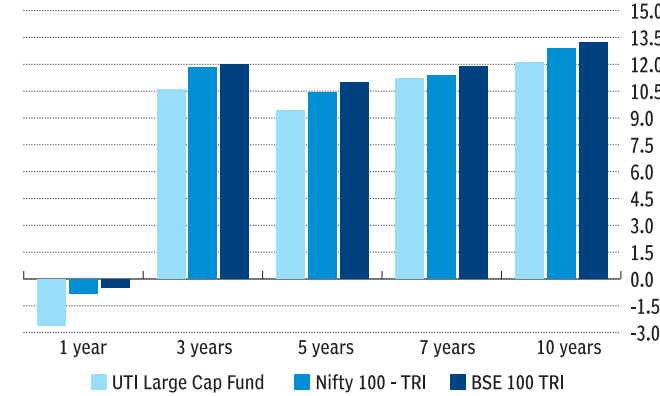
FUND CALL. UTI Large Cap, in its 40th year, has seen returns turn lukewarm for long, staying below peers and benchmarks



10.3 per cent. A similar SIP in the Nifty 100 TRI would have delivered 11 per cent.

UTI Large Cap has an upside capture ratio of 96, indicating that its NAV rises less than the benchmark during market rallies. The fund has a downside capture ratio of 93.8, indicating that the scheme's NAV falls less than the benchmark during periods of correction. A score of 100 indicates that a fund per-

Lagging benchmarks over all timeframes (%)



Source: ACE MF, Valueresearch; CAGR data for direct plan as of April 1, 2026

forms exactly in line with its benchmark. Overall, these ratios are consistent with the fund's prolonged underperformance. This inference is based on data from March 2021-March 2026. All return figures and ratios pertain to the direct plan of the fund.

CHURNING MODERATELY

UTI Large cap sticks to being bluechip in character and principle with such stocks accounting for more than 87 per cent of the portfolio at most times.

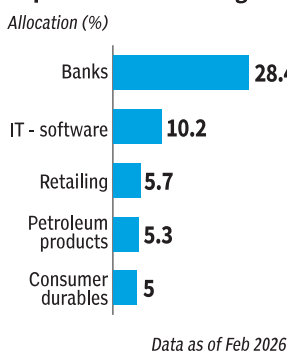
Mid and small-caps find utmost 8-10 per cent weight in the fund's holdings. Cash and debt

positions are restricted to 2-4 per cent most of the time. As with most funds, more so from the large-cap stable, banks figure among the top holdings of the scheme.

Exposure to HDFC Bank, a major underperformer in the past few years and holding on to the likes of Kotak Mahindra Bank and Bajaj Finance which have had a weak run, have hurt returns.

IT-software has consistently been the second largest holding for UTI Large Cap fund, despite the underperformance due to AI disruptions. Stocks such as Infosys, which corrected heavily,

Top five sector holdings



still find a place among the top holdings.

Not giving higher weight to segments that have done well such as pharma/healthcare, automobiles, and so forth, has been another reason for the fund's underperformance.

Instead, retailing and consumer durables figure among key holdings. Stocks such as DMart, ITC and weaker insurance picks such as HDFC Life have also weighed on returns.

Though the portfolio shows a degree of value orientation, that approach has not delivered sufficiently even over longer periods.

Money managers hunker down as war rages

GLOBAL VIEW. Conflict wiped trillions off stocks, pushed oil past \$100 and repriced wagers on interest rates and inflation

Bloomberg

Five weeks of war in Iran have wiped trillions off global stocks, pushed oil past \$100 and kept it there and repriced wagers on interest rates and inflation.

This week was supposed to bring clarity on when, and how, all that disruption would end. Investors are still waiting.

US President Donald Trump's primetime address on Wednesday signalled more attacks and imminent peace simultaneously, offered no framework for reopening the Strait of Hormuz and effectively told allies to figure it out themselves. By Thursday morning, stocks had plunged — then recovered almost entirely on a single headline about Iran drafting a shipping protocol with Oman. Not a ceasefire. Not a reopening. A monitoring framework. That a market can swing 1.5 per cent on that little tells you where investor psychology stands. On Tuesday, the S&P 500 had surged 2.9 per cent for its best day since May on hopes the conflict was winding down. That arc — relief, disappointment, panic, relief — is the pattern that has defined this war for markets. The benchmark still ended the week up more than 3 per cent, its best showing since November. But the rally was built on headlines, not resolution.

Brent crude, which has gained roughly 50 per cent since the conflict began — the biggest monthly surge in decades — jumped back near \$110 at the end of the holiday-shortened week. Wells Fargo Securities LLC cut its year-end S&P 500 target. And the International



Energy Agency warned that April will be far worse for oil supply than March.

'NO CLEAR END GAME'

All that is the backdrop against which money managers are now making real decisions. David Royal, chief financial and investment officer at Minneapolis-based Thrivent with \$212 billion in assets, watched the speech from a New York hotel room expecting a defining moment.

"There's not a clear end game for market disruption," he said.

He's been quietly moderating growth-stock exposure in favour of value without panicking. He's now watching beaten-up blue chips for a chance to buy in the coming weeks. "When it's least comfortable to add equity is when you should be doing that," he said. "Markets bottom

MIXED SIGNALS

US President Trump signalled more attacks and imminent peace simultaneously, but, offered no framework for reopening the Strait of Hormuz, and told allies to figure it out

when uncertainty is at its maximum."

Others aren't waiting around. Florian Ielpo, head of macro at Lombard Odier Investment Managers, has already scaled his portfolio back to what he calls cruise mode — 40 per cent in risky assets, the rest in bonds, commodities and volatility hedges. "I don't buy the argument of the value of staying in-

vested," he said. "Sometimes there is a shock and you need to be disinvested."

He compared the moment to turbulence on a flight — strap in and wait it out — but said oil between \$100 and \$120 creates pressure that becomes overwhelming if it persists. Ielpo is now publishing daily notes in response to client demand and says outlook calls are drawing roughly double the usual attendance. "There's a strong need for clarity," he said. "You hear the word 'uncertain' a lot."

Rushabh Amin at Allspring Global Investments argues the shock is transmitting through rates and the dollar rather than hitting equities head on — and that repricing is what's moving everything else. His highest-conviction trade is long dollar, which he considers contrarian.

ALERTS.

Nifty LargeMidcap250 Plus 8-13 Yr G-Sec 70:30 Index Fund

Zerodha Nifty LargeMidcap250 Plus 8-13 Yr G-Sec 70:30 Index Fund is an open-ended scheme replicating/tracking



Nifty LargeMidcap250 Plus 8-13 yr G-Sec 70:30 Index - TRI. The NFO closes on April 15. Entry load is not applicable and exit load is nil. The minimum subscription amount is ₹100 and in multiples of any amount thereafter. The performance will be benchmarked against Nifty LargeMidcap250 Plus 8-13 yr

G-Sec 70:30 Index; its fund manager is Kedarnath Mirajkar. The objective is passive investment in securities replicating the composition of the Nifty LargeMidcap250 Plus 8-13 yr G-Sec 70:30 Index, subject to tracking error.

JioBlackRock Large Cap Fund

JioBlackRock Large Cap Fund is an open-ended equity scheme predominantly investing in large-cap stocks. The NFO closes on April 7, 2026. The entry load is not



applicable and exit load is nil for the scheme. The minimum subscription amount is ₹500 and any amount thereafter. The performance of the scheme will be benchmarked against BSE 100 Index (TRI); its fund managers are Tanvi Kacheria and Sahil Chaudhary. The investment objective of the scheme is to

provide returns that, before expenses, align with the total returns of the securities constituting the Nifty MidSmallcap400 50:50 Index, subject to tracking error.

ETF movers

Top ETFs (Exchange Traded Funds) traded on NSE based on weekly change in price

ETF	NAV (₹)	Price (₹)	Weekly change in price (%)	Volume traded in the last week (in '000s)
MOSL Nasdaq Q50 ETF	92.8	109.3	8.2	838
MOSL S&P BSE Quality ETF	182.7	190.0	5.4	37
DSP Nifty Smallcap 250 ETF	14.8	14.8	4.3	919
MOSL BSE Select IPO ETF	38.9	38.9	4.2	2,368
Groww Nifty Ind Defence ETF	76.0	76.2	3.6	2,084
MOSL Nasdaq 100 ETF	218.7	239.5	3.3	4,695
DSP Nifty IT ETF	32.0	32.1	3.2	1,902
GOLD ETFs				
Bandhan Gold ETF	145.6	149.1	4.6	423
Edelweiss Gold ETF	145.7	146.9	3.2	397
Angel One Gold ETF	13.6	13.7	2.9	2,522

Source: Bloomberg. Returns as on April 2, 2026

Best NPS plans

Top pension funds in each category based on 5-year CAGR

Name of the fund	NAV (₹) as on Apr 2	Returns (% CAGR)			Assets (₹ cr)
		3-year	5-year	10-year	
TIER I: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	50.3	12.8	11.8	13.4	75,761
Kotak Pension Fund	63.0	13.4	12.4	13.2	4,578
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	68.0	13.8	12.3	13.1	27,525
TIER I: GOVERNMENT BOND PLANS					
LIC Pension Fund	30.0	6.4	5.7	8.2	8,462
SBI Pension Fund	40.2	6.5	5.6	7.7	27,593
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	37.0	6.3	5.6	7.6	20,638
TIER I: CORPORATE DEBT PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	29.9	8.0	6.9	8.3	32,602
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	45.0	7.9	6.7	8.1	12,907
SBI Pension Fund	45.2	7.8	6.6	8.1	14,642
TIER II: EQUITY PLANS					
HDFC Pension Fund	43.4	12.7	11.7	13.4	1,836
ICICI Prudential Pension Fund	53.8	13.7	12.3	13.1	773
Kotak Pension Fund	55.4	13.4	12.4	13.1	224

*Source: Value Research. Returns as on April 2, 2026

Top PMS schemes

Based on 5-year returns

AMC	Strategy	AUM (in ₹ cr)	Returns (% CAGR)		
			1-year	3-year	5-year
LARGE CAP					
Tulsian PMS	Tulsian PMS	288	26.8	24.0	22.8
ICICI Pru	Largecap	882	24.9	23.7	20.2
Standard Chartered Securities India	SC Autograph Vibrant India Equity	NA	21.4	21.9	17.3
Ksema Wealth	Alpha	16	24.4	19.5	16.4
MULTI CAP					
Asit C Mehta Invest. Intermediates	ACE - Multicap	118	19.1	32.9	25.9
ICICI Pru	Largecap	1,077	31.1	30.1	25.6
Shepherd's Hill Financial Advisors	Value Magno	118	23.9	32.4	24.9
Bonanza Portfolio	Edge	NA	10.2	22.3	24.8
Invasset	Growth Pro Max	359	11.3	36.7	24.6
Buoyant Capital	Opportunities	9,127	30.1	26.1	24.2
MID-CAP					
NAFA Asset Managers	Emerging Bluechip	NA	12.3	18.1	19.1
Master Portfolio Services	Master Trust India Growth	346	20.0	16.2	19.0
Unifi Capital	APJ 20	NA	12.2	17.8	18.2
Sundaram Alternate Assets	SELF Portfolio	NA	35.8	22.6	17.3
SMALL CAP					
Aequitas Invest. Consultancy	India Opportunities	4,457	61.8	51.5	46.6
Counter Cyclical Investments	Diversified Long Term Value	793	-0.2	22.8	37.4
Equitree Capital Advisors	Emerging Opportunities	1,108	-5.3	31.2	25.1
Accuracap	Dynamo	13	13.3	29.7	23.6

*Source: PMS Bazaar. Returns as on February 28, 2026

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research Bureau

Nifty 50 (22,713) and Nifty Bank (51,549) declined 0.5 per cent and 1.4 per cent respectively last week.

Data show that FIIs (Foreign Institutional Investors) are not adding to short positions. In fact, there has been a marginal reduction in net shorts on index futures and, by cutting net long positions in puts, they have reduced downside hedges. On the other hand, retail participants continue to exhibit a bullish bias as they hold net long positions in index futures and calls.

Overall, while FIIs have pared some bearish bets and retail traders remain constructive, this does not confirm a bullish reversal. A sustained uptrend would require fresh long build-up.

Here is our analysis of Nifty 50 and Nifty Bank derivatives alongside the trade recommendation:

NIFTY 50
Nifty futures (April) (22,767) declined 0.6 per cent last week, a truncated one with only three trading sessions. For the second consecutive week, the contract has closed below the key support at 23,000. As long as this level remains unbroken on the upside, the bias will stay bearish.

A continuation of the decline from the current level of 22,767 can drag Nifty futures towards the 22,100–22,000 support band. However, if the contract manages to break above 23,000, the upswing could extend to 23,700, where the 21-day moving average coincides.

That said, futures positioning indicates fresh short build-up, suggesting that a recovery may not be immediate. As Nifty April



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BROAD TREND

- Bearish bias intact in index futures
- Key resistances holding firm across indices
- Downside risk persists below critical levels

Strategy: Short Nifty futures (April) at 22,900. Place stop-loss at 23,200. Revise the stop-loss to 22,550 when the contract falls to 22,300. Book profits at 22,100.

NIFTY BANK
Nifty Bank futures (April) (51,818) declined 1.4 per cent last week. It closed below the support at 52,500, indicating that bears remain in control. Although the contract recovered partially from the sharp fall seen early in the week, there are no clear signs of a bullish reversal.

Importantly, the contract has seen fresh short build-up. As it declined 1.4 per cent last week, open interest increased from 18 lakh contracts to 24.7 lakh contracts.

The PCR of April options stood at 0.86 at the end of last week. A ratio below 1 indicates relatively higher call writing compared to puts, suggesting a bearish bias.

Call option strikes with high OI include 52,000, 53,000 and 54,000, which can act as resistance levels. On the downside, the 51,000 and 50,000 put strikes have considerable OI and may offer support.

Overall, the bias remains bearish and Nifty Bank futures may see another leg of decline before any meaningful trend reversal.

Strategy: Short Nifty Bank futures (April) at 52,600. Place stop-loss at 54,000. Book profits at 50,000.

Options liquidity: Volumes vs OI

MASTERING DERIVATIVES. Why change in OI is more meaningful than volumes for trading

Venkatesh Bangaruswamy

Open interest (OI) is an important metric for trading options. Can you discern an option's liquidity from its OI instead of its trading volumes? This week, we discuss why OI, specifically the change in OI, is more meaningful than volumes.

OI VS VOLUMES

Open interest is a metric that captures the total open position in a strike as of a trading day. Volumes represent the total contracts traded during the day whereas OI is a cumulative number that starts from the day a strike commences trading. Suppose total volumes in a strike on a trading day is 10,000 contracts. If all these contracts, long and short, are closed by the end of the day, then there will be no change to the OI carried forward from the previous day. If say 2,000 of total 10,000 contracts are not closed during the day, then 2,000 contracts will be added to the OI carried forward from the previous day.

When you go long on a call option, your objective is to sell the position later and take profits. As



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QUICK TIP

Volumes represent the total contracts traded during the day whereas OI is a cumulative number that starts from the day a strike commences trading

the underlying moves up, the call option that you bought can become in-the-money (ITM). ITM options carry intrinsic value, which increases its absolute price. So, ITM options are less preferred, the more the intrinsic value they carry. This means you

should sell the option before it becomes deep ITM, say, four strikes below the Nifty Index's current spot price. Note that you trade European options, which means you cannot exercise the options become expiry.

This makes it important that the strike you hold is liquid when you want to close your long call position. The issue is that volumes on the day you buy the call cannot help you determine if the strike will be liquid when you eventually sell the position. Why?

Suppose you buy the 22500 strike when the Nifty Index is at 22476. The volumes will be high

because it is an at-the-money (ATM) strike, as it is closest to the spot price (technically correct way to identify an ATM strike is to choose the one with a delta closest to 0.50).

If the Nifty Index were to move up the next day to, say, 22650, trading interest is likely to shift to the 22700 strike. The 22500 that you bought will now be 150 points ITM, attracting less trader interest. So, high volumes the previous day on a strike does not mean high volumes the next day too.

OPTIONAL READING

Traders who take short position should come back to the market to close their position. If more short positions are carried forward on a trading day, greater the chances that you will be able to find a counterparty to close your long position with less mispricing. The change in OI captures the number of contracts that have taken an opposite position to the one you want to initiate, making it an important metric to understand options' liquidity.

The author offers training programmes for individuals to manage their personal investments

Negative bias

BULLION CUES. Decline likely ahead

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Gold (\$4,676/ounce) and silver (\$73/ounce) appreciated 4 per cent and 4.7 per cent respectively last week. MCX gold futures (₹1,49,680 per 10 gm) rose 1.6 per cent whereas MCX silver futures (₹2,32,495 per kg) was up 2 per cent.

MCX-GOLD (₹1,49,680)

Gold futures (June) gained in three out of four sessions last week, hinting that the bulls may be gaining traction. However, the contract could not surpass a resistance at ₹1,55,000. Also, the price continues to remain below the 21-day moving average.

Gold futures can see a fresh fall from current level towards ₹1,32,000 in the near-term.

But if gold futures recovers and surpasses the resistance at ₹1,55,000, it can rally to ₹1,62,000.

However, as the resistance stays true at the moment, the likelihood of a decline is high.

Trade strategy: Sell gold futures (June) at ₹1,50,000. Target and stop-loss can be ₹1,32,000 and ₹1,57,000 respectively.



MCX-SILVER (₹2,32,495)

Silver futures (May), too, rose until Wednesday and saw a decline only on Thursday. Consequently, it posted a gain on a weekly basis.

However, the contract failed to cross over the resistance at ₹2,50,000. This shows that while the bulls attempted to take control, the bears have defended it, at least for now.

The price action shows a negative bias and we anticipate a decline from the current level, possibly to ₹2,00,000. But in case silver futures breaks out of ₹2,50,000, it can extend the upswing to ₹2,80,000.

That said, so long as the hurdle at ₹2,50,000 holds, the bears will have an advantage.

Trade strategy: Sell silver futures (May) at ₹2,39,000. Target and stop-loss can be ₹2,00,000 and ₹2,55,000.

Strength intact

CRUDE CHECK. Rally may extend this week

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Crude oil prices firmed up last week. Brent crude oil futures on the Intercontinental Exchange (ICE) (\$109/barrel) and crude oil futures in the domestic market (₹10,408/barrel) were up 3.5 per cent and 10.8 per cent respectively. Below is an analysis.

BRENT FUTURES (\$109)

Brent crude oil futures after opening with a gap-up last Monday, could not extend the rally and dropped. However, on Thursday, it rose 7.8 per cent, indicating the broader bullish bias is intact.

The rebound happened on the back of the 21-day moving average at \$100. The longer lower wicks on the recent weekly candles denote good buying interest, particularly between \$96 and \$104.

Going ahead, there is a good chance for Brent crude futures to rise, possibly to \$120. A breakout of this can lift it to \$130.

Only a decisive breach of the support at \$96 will turn the outlook bearish. Support below \$96 is at \$90.



MCX-CRUDE OIL (₹10,408)

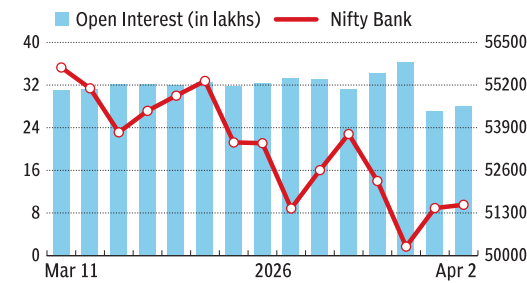
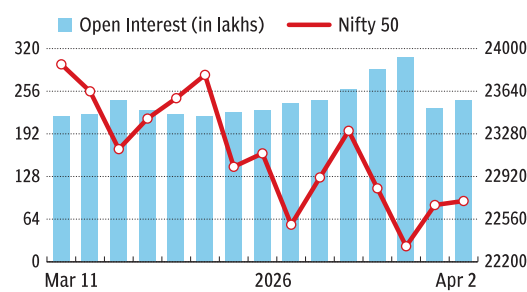
Crude oil futures on the MCX performed better than the Brent crude futures by posting a bigger gain of 10.8 per cent. It marked a new all-time high of ₹10,640 on Thursday before moderating to ₹10,408.

The chart shows a strong bullish momentum and so, we might see further upside in the coming days. The contract can rally to ₹11,200 soon.

Nevertheless, there is a good chance for the contract to see a moderation to ₹9,800–10,000 price band. The corrective decline might extend to ₹9,300 before the crude oil futures makes fresh highs.

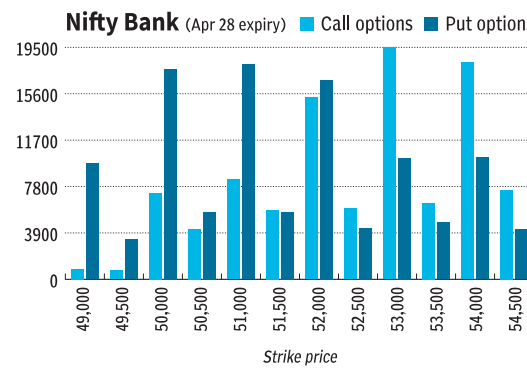
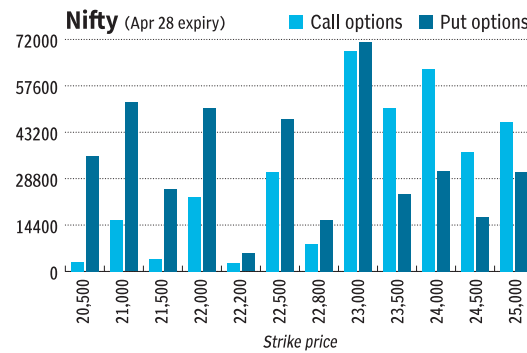
Trade strategy: Go long at ₹10,000 and ₹9,400. Stop-loss can be ₹8,700. Book profits at ₹11,200. The contract can experience high volatility and so, risk-averse traders can stay out.

Cumulative Open Interest (Futures)



Open Interest chain

Put-Call ratio Nifty **0.95** | Nifty Bank **0.86** (as on Apr 2)



Change in Open Interest (OI)

Scrip	FII		Retail	
	As on Apr 2	Weekly change %	As on Apr 2	Weekly change %
Future Index Long	68058	10	267437	-7
Future Index Short	336078	-2	89885	-26
Net Futures	-268020	-4	177552	7
Index Call options Long	411595	-46	2208301	-26
Index Call options Short	661152	-32	2020264	-24
Net Call options	-249557	19	188037	-40
Index Put options Long	784638	-26	1927751	-13
Index Put options Short	460252	-30	2303469	-16
Net Put Options	324386	-21	-375718	-29

FII positioning indicates a reduction in bearish exposure through short covering on index futures and unwinding of hedges in put longs, suggesting that the recent downtrend may be losing momentum.

Stocks that witnessed major change in OI

Company	Price (₹)	Weekly price change %	OI (in lakh)	Weekly OI change %
RISE (as on Apr 2)				
SAMMAANCAP	146.95	-0.9	1583.7	9.0
ASHOKLEY	148.44	-9.0	2850.1	2.3
FALL (as on Apr 2)				
INDIGO	4,193.50	2.3	128.7	-49.7
TATAELXSI	4,241.30	1.9	24.2	-47.1
IRFC	91.84	-0.7	1014.2	-45.1
ANGELONE	240.85	2.4	355.5	-44.8
360ONE	933.85	-4.5	28.5	-44.8

Stocks in F&O ban (for trade on Apr 6)

Nil

Change in OI and market positioning

Symbol	Expiry date (2026)	Price (₹)	OI	Indication
		(Weekly change %)		
COMMODITIES (as on Apr 2)				
ALUMINIUM	30-Apr	354.4 (4.3)	3,028 (4)	Long build-up
COPPER	30-Apr	1,155.1 (0.4)	9,094 (-2)	Short covering
CRUDEOIL	20-Apr	10,408.0 (10.8)	15,669 (0)	Long build-up
CRUDEOILM	20-Apr	10,403.0 (10.7)	51,544 (-17)	Short covering
GOLD	5-Jun	1,49,680.0 (1.6)	6,648 (11)	Long build-up
GOLDGUINEA	30-Apr	1,19,312.0 (2.0)	15,567 (-11)	Short covering
GOLDM	5-May	1,48,140.0 (1.5)	30,171 (21)	Long build-up
GOLDPETAL	30-Apr	14,935.0 (1.9)	1,92,646 (-5)	Short covering
GOLDTEN	30-Apr	1,48,539.0 (1.6)	30,575 (-17)	Short covering
LEAD	30-Apr	195.3 (1.0)	316 (127)	Long build-up
NATURALGAS	27-Apr	264.0 (-8.9)	36,613 (76)	Short build-up
SILVER	5-May	2,32,495.0 (2.0)	5,778 (2)	Long build-up
SILVERM	30-Apr	2,35,645.0 (1.5)	13,696 (1)	Long build-up
SILVERMIC	30-Apr	2,35,759.0 (1.5)	49,856 (1)	Long build-up
ZINC	30-Apr	323.2 (2.5)	1,722 (-23)	Short covering
CURRENCIES (as on Apr 2)				
USDINR	28-Apr	93.68 (-1.5)	17,28,267 (18)	Short build-up
EURINR	28-Apr	109.06 (-0.6)	25,596 (3)	Short build-up
GBPINR	28-Apr	124.69 (-1.5)	24,043 (4)	Short build-up
JPYINR	28-Apr	59.27 (-1.2)	34 (10)	Short build-up

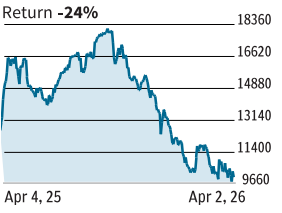
F&O Strategy

Buy Dixon Technologies

KS Badri Narayanan

The stock of Dixon Technologies (₹9,920.50) is ruling at a crucial level. Immediate support levels are at ₹9,750 and ₹9,638. Resistance levels are at ₹10,026 and ₹13,350. A close above the latter will turn the long-term outlook positive.

While a clear signal will emerge only if the stock either breaches the crucial support at ₹9,300 or rises above the resistance at ₹11,400, we expect a technical bounce as the stock saw a sharp slide in the last few days.



F&O pointers: Dixon Technologies April futures closed with a discount at ₹9,817 against the spot price of ₹9,920.50. From 2.91 lakh shares on March 16, open interest jumped to 29.32 lakh shares on April 2, even as the stock remained volatile.

Strategy: Consider going long on Dixon Technologies April futures with a stop-loss at ₹9,732. This strategy is strictly for traders with a high risk appetite and note that futures requires higher margin commitments. So, risk-averse traders can stay out.

If the futures opens and stays above ₹9,825 on Monday, stop-loss can be shifted to ₹9,800. Traders can aim for a target of ₹9,920. High risk traders can even aim for a target of ₹10,010 but with trailing stop-loss.

We suggest booking profits promptly at suggested levels as Dixon Technologies is a high beta stock.

Note: The recommendations are based on technical analysis and F&O positions. There is a risk of loss in trading

Short Take

F&O lot size revision

Akhil Nallamuthu
bl. research bureau

Last week, the NSE and BSE announced revisions to the lot size of derivative contracts for several stocks.

On the NSE, the lot size of 43 stocks will be revised upward, while that of 5 stocks will be reduced. In the case of 2 stocks, the revised lot size will decline, but the new size will not be a multiple of the existing lot. The remaining 151 stocks in the derivatives segment will continue with the current lot size.



Likewise, on the BSE, 43 stocks will witness an increase in lot size and 5 stocks will see a reduction. In addition, 1 stock will have its lot size cut, although the revised size will not be in the multiple of the current lot. The lot size of the remaining 150 stocks will remain unchanged.

It must be noted that HUDCO, Piramal Pharma, Tata Technologies and Torrent Power are not part of this revision, as these stocks are being excluded from the F&O segment. April will be the last available expiry.

As for implementation, the revised lot sizes will take effect from the July series on the NSE, whereas on the BSE, the changes will come into force from the May series.

These revisions are part of a periodic exercise aimed at keeping the contract value in the ₹5–10 lakh range. Stocks whose contract value has moved above ₹10 lakh will see a reduction in lot size, while those that have fallen below ₹5 lakh will undergo an upward revision.

Gurumurthy K
bl. research bureau

Nifty 50, Sensex and the Nifty Bank index fell for the sixth consecutive week. The benchmark indices tested their crucial supports and have bounced back well from there. It is now critical if the indices are going to see a strong follow-through rise from here or not. The next few weeks are going to be very crucial for the Indian equity market. A strong recovery is needed to avoid a much steeper fall, and to get some relief. As such the price action in April will have the potential to determine the trend for the rest of the year.

FPIs sell
The Foreign Portfolio Investors (FPIs) continued to sell Indian equities for the fifth consecutive week. There was a net outflow of about \$2.5 billion from the equity segment last week. The FPIs have sold about \$14.8 billion in the last five weeks.

NIFTY (22,713.10)
Short-term view: The crucial support at 22,200 held well last week. Nifty has to see a good follow-through rise from here and rise above 23,000 to get a breather. If it does, then a rise to 23,400-23,500 is possible. The upside can extend even to 23,800-23,900.

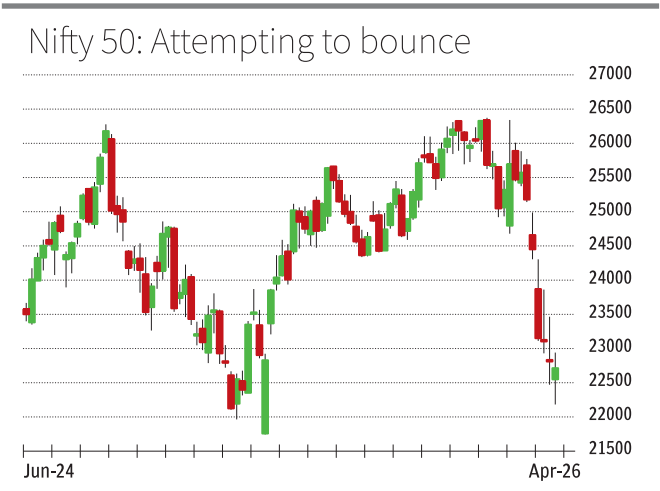
If this rise happens in the next few weeks, then there is also a possibility of seeing a sideways consolidation between 22,200 and 23,500/23,900.

On the other hand, the failure to rise past 23,000 and a fall below 22,200 can increase the selling pressure. In that case, Nifty can fall to 21,800-21,700.

Medium-term view: As mentioned last week, 22,200-22,000 is a crucial support zone which is holding well now. A strong rise above 24,000 from here can turn the sentiment positive to revisit 26,000-26,400 on the upside again.

An eventual break above 26,400 will indicate a bullish breakout and boost the momentum. It will then clear the way for the rally to 28,000 and 30,000 in the long term.

Nifty will come under danger only if it breaks below 22,000 first, and then declines below 21,700 eventually. If that happens, 21,200-21,000 can be seen on the downside.



NIFTY BANK (51,548.75)
Short-term view: Nifty Bank index fell beyond our expected level of 50,500. It touched a low of 49,954.85 and then has risen back from there. The immediate picture is unclear. Crucial support is at 49,900. Immediate resistance is 52,200. If the index manages to breach this hurdle this week, a rise to 53,500-54,000, the next important resistance zone, can be seen.

But, failure to rise above 52,200 from here can keep the index under pressure to break below 49,900. Such a break can drag the Nifty Bank index down to 48,500-48,300.

Medium-term view: Nifty Bank index must sustain above 49,900 and rise above 54,000 subsequently in order to regain the bullish momentum. If that happens, then the rise to 60,000 will come into the picture from a medium-term perspective.

That will keep intact the long-term bullish view to see 64,000-65,000 and 68,000-69,000.

There is also a possibility of getting a sideways consolidation between 49,900 and 54,000.

Nifty Bank index will come under more selling pressure if it breaks below 49,900 and declines lower than 48,300 subsequently. If that happens, there is a danger of seeing 46,800 or even 46,000 on the downside.

SENSEX (73,319.55)
Short-term view: Sensex broke below 72,250 but did not sustain. It has risen back well after making a low of 71,545.81.

Immediate support is at 72,800. Below that, 72,000-71,500 is the next important support zone. If the Sensex manages to sustain above 72,800 itself, then a rise to 76,000-77,000 is possible in the coming weeks.

CRUCIAL SUPPORTS

- Nifty 50: 22,200, 22,000
- Sensex: 72,000, 71,500
- Nifty Bank: 49,900, 48,500

Sensex will come under the danger of a deeper fall only if it breaks below 71,500.

Medium-term view: The region around 71,500 is a crucial support zone. Sensex has to sustain above this support and then rise above 77,500 subsequently to bring back the bullish view. It will then open the doors for a rally to 86,000 in the medium term and 90,000 and even 98,000 in the long term.

Sensex will come under the danger of further fall if it breaks below 71,500. In that case, a fall to 69,000 can happen.

NIFTY MIDCAP 150 (19,805.50)

The support in the 19,200-19,000 region was tested last week as expected. This support zone has also held very well in line with our expectation. The index touched a low of 19,218 and then has bounced back from there. So, our overall view continues to remain intact from what we said last week.

As long as the index stays above 19,000, the bias will be positive. A rise to 21,000 can be seen in the short term. An eventual break above 21,000 can then clear the way for a rise to 22,800 in the coming months

The Nifty Midcap 150 index

has to breach 22,800 to gain bullish momentum. That in turn will bring back the chances of the rally to 26,000-26,500 in the medium term and 28,000-28,500 in the long term.

The index has to break below 19,000 to negate the aforementioned bullish view. If that happens, 18,300-18,000 can be seen on the downside. Such fall will make it difficult for the index to rise back above 21,000 immediately.

NIFTY SMALLCAP 250 (14,724.45)

The Nifty Smallcap 250 index is managing to hold well above 14,000. That is in line with our broader bullish view. A rise to 16,000 is possible as long as the index stays above 14,000.

A break above 16,000 will then increase the potential for the index to target 22,500-23,000 in the long term.

The bullish view will go wrong only if the index declines below 14,000. In that case, it can fall to 13,000.

bl.portfolio

video

Watch bl. Guru share the Nifty and Bank Nifty technical outlook for this week

English

Tamil

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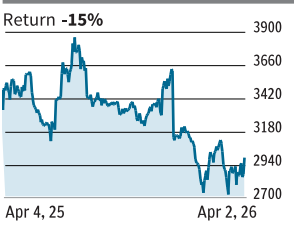
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MOVERS & SHAKERS

AKHIL NALLAMUTHU bl. research bureau

Akzo Nobel India (₹2,984.65)

Trend reversal on the cards

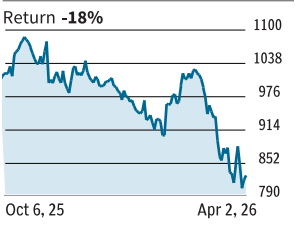


The stock of Akzo Nobel India, since November 2024, has been on a decline. However, since early February, it has stayed flat, denoting that the bears are losing momentum. This is happening on the back of the support at ₹2,700. The chart shows that there is a barrier

ahead at ₹3,100. Nevertheless, we expect the scrip to eventually surpass this level, which can open the door for a rally to ₹4,000. Given the bullish expectations, we suggest buying now at ₹2,984 and accumulating at ₹2,750. Stop-loss can be ₹2,500. On a rally to ₹3,400 and ₹3,700, revise the stop-loss to ₹3,100 and ₹3,550 respectively. Book profits at ₹4,000.

Bajaj Finance (₹826.40)

At a strong base

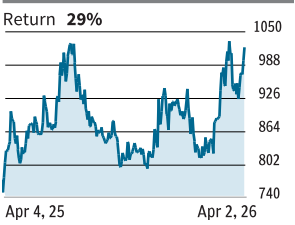


The stock of Bajaj Finance, after hitting a record high of ₹1,102.45 in October, has been on a decline. It lost nearly 20 per cent last month. But going ahead, the stock is expected to stabilise as there is a strong support band between ₹740 and ₹780. A couple of trendlines

and the 50-month moving average coincides within this price band. So, eventually, the stock is expected to reverse the trend upwards. Therefore, participants can buy at ₹826 and accumulate at ₹760. Place a stop-loss at ₹650. When the scrip rises to ₹1,000 and ₹1,100, revise the stop-loss to ₹900 and ₹1,020 respectively. Liquidate the longs at ₹1,200.

Natco Pharma (₹1,027.85)

Breakout anticipated



The stock of Natco Pharma has been displaying a bullish bias since mid-February. Substantiating this, the scrip has rebounded well off the support at ₹800 twice over the past one month. That said, the chart shows that the stock has been trading sideways for the past one

year. That is, it has largely been trading between ₹750 and ₹1,050. Given the prevailing positive momentum as indicated by the recent rise, we anticipate a breakout soon. A breakout of ₹1,050 can lift the stock to ₹1,600 in the medium term. So, buy at ₹1,027 and ₹900. Stop-loss can be ₹730. On a rally to ₹1,200 and ₹1,400, revise the stop-loss to ₹1,100 and ₹1,300 respectively. Exit at ₹1,600.

Short-lived bounce

Gurumurthy K

bl. research bureau

The Dow Jones Industrial Average, S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite witnessed strong bounce-back last week. This has provided some relief after having beaten down for five consecutive weeks. The Dow Jones rose 2.96 per cent. The S&P 500 and the NASDAQ Composite index were up 3.36 per cent and 4.44 per cent respectively. Will this bounce sustain? Is this just a corrective rise before the next leg of fall? Here is our analysis:

DOW JONES (46,504.67)

Near-term resistances are at 46,700 and 47,050. If the Dow manages to breach 47,050 decisively, it can gain some more strength. That in turn can take the index further up to 48,000-48,300 in the next few weeks. The price action thereafter is going to be very crucial.

Failure to rise past 48,300 can drag the index down to 45,000 again. A strong follow-through rise above 48,300 is needed to bring back the bullishness. Only then, 50,000 and higher levels can be seen again.

On the other hand, if the Dow turns down from 47,050 itself, then there is a danger of breaking below the 45,000-44,900 support zone. Such a break can drag it down to 44,000.

S&P 500 (6,582.69)

The rise back above 6,470 has reduced the danger of seeing the fall to 6,200 immediately. However, the threat has not been negated completely. The region between 6,470-6,440 will be a good immediate support.

Resistance is at 6,645. A break above it can take the S&P 500 index up to 6,750. An extended rise to 6,800 is also a possibility. A strong rise above 6,800 is needed to turn the outlook bullish again.

A reversal anywhere from the 6,750-6,800 region will keep bearish view intact. It can then take the index down to 6,450-6,400 again. An eventual break below 6,400 thereafter will bring back the danger of seeing 6,200-6,180 on the downside.



POSITIVE BIAS

The US 10Yr Treasury Yield is likely to sustain above 4.25 per cent and rise back to keep the bullish view intact

NASDAQ COMPOSITE (21,879.18)

Key resistances are coming up in the 22,000-22,150 region which can cap the upside. A downward reversal from this resistance zone can drag the NASDAQ Composite index down to 21,000-20,900 again. It will also keep the broader downtrend intact.

That in turn will keep the downside open to see 20,500-20,300 or even 19,900-19,700 over the medium term.

To avoid this fall, the NASDAQ Composite index has to see a sustained rise above 22,500.

DOLLAR OUTLOOK

The dollar index (100.19) continues to oscillate in a range. There is no major change in our view.

The region between 99 and 98.50 will be a strong support zone. A rise to 101-101.20 is still on the cards. The index is likely to breach 101.20 eventually.

That in turn will open the doors for a rise to 103-104 over the medium term.

Failure to breach 101.20 can drag the index down to 100-99 again. In that case, 98.50-101.20 can be the broad trading range.

A fall below 98.50 is needed to turn the outlook negative.

TREASURY YIELDS

The US 10Yr Treasury Yield (4.31 per cent) fell last week. However, the support in the 4.28-4.25 per cent region is holding well. As long as the yield stays above 4.25 per cent, the bias will remain positive. That will keep our bullish view intact to see 4.6 per cent on the upside in the coming weeks. A decisive break above 4.45 per cent will clear the way for this rise.

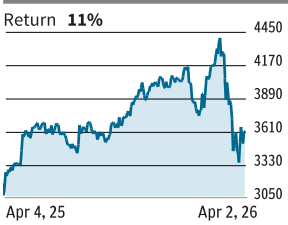
The 10Yr Yield has to fall below 4.2 per cent to come under pressure. If that happens, a fall to 4 per cent is possible. That in turn will negate the rise to 4.6 per cent.

TECH QUERY



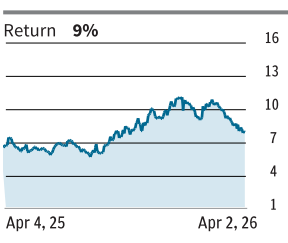
GURUMURTHY K
bl.research bureau

I have purchased Larsen & Toubro (L&T) shares at ₹4,300 for the long term. What should I do now?
Prosenjit Bhattacharya, West Bengal



Larsen & Toubro (₹3,614): Barring the short-lived rise to ₹4,440 seen in February, the stock is broadly range-bound. A fall to ₹3,100-3,000 is possible in the short term. A break below ₹3,000 is less likely. A sustained rise above ₹4,100 can strengthen the momentum. That in turn can take L&T share price up to ₹5,000-6,000 in the medium term. From a long-term perspective, the stock can target ₹8,000 on the upside. Hold the stock. Buy more on dips at ₹3,220. Keep the stop-loss at ₹2,830. Move the stop-loss higher to ₹3,940 as soon as the stock goes up to ₹4,250. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹5,030 and ₹6,750 when the price touches ₹6,100 and ₹7,300 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹8,000.

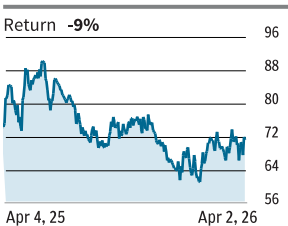
I have shares of Vodafone Idea. I bought the stock this year at ₹9.75. Can I hold it for ₹15?
Jasneet



Vodafone Idea (₹8.60): The short-term outlook is negative. The price action since mid-November last year indicates a head and shoulder pattern on the chart. The fall below ₹9.75 last month confirms this pattern.

That leaves the outlook bearish. The stock can fall to ₹6.5-6.25 from here. A strong bounce there after may have the potential to take the share price up to ₹11. So, a rise to ₹15 looks unlikely. You may have to exit the stock now and come out with minimum loss. You can consider re-entering the stock at ₹6.5. Keep the stop-loss at ₹5.3. Exit the stock at ₹11. The stock will come under danger for a fall to ₹4-3 only if it breaks below ₹6.

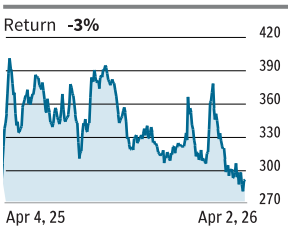
I have bought HFCL shares at ₹67.80. What can be the target for a two-year outlook?
Devang



HFCL (₹72): A crucial support is around ₹55. As long as the stock stays above this support, the broader bias will remain positive. Key resistance is at ₹95. The stock has to breach this hurdle in order to gain momentum and rally to

₹200-205 over the next couple of years. A sideways range of ₹55-95 is also a possibility for some time. So, you need to be patient to hold this stock. Keep a stop-loss at ₹38. Buy more at ₹64 again if you get a dip. Move the stop-loss up to ₹78 when the price goes up to ₹98. Revise the stop-loss higher to ₹83, ₹108 and ₹135 when the price touches ₹102, ₹135 and ₹168 respectively. Exit the stock at ₹200.

I have purchased Senco Gold at ₹558. What is the outlook?
Suneeth Bhat, Sirsi, Karnataka



Senco Gold (₹289): The broader trend is down since September 2024. Immediate resistance is at ₹296. There is room to test ₹265, a crucial support. A strong bounce from there and a subsequent rise above ₹295 is

needed to get some breather. If that happens, there are good chances to see a rise to ₹350. However, going back up to your purchase price is not looking likely. Buying more around ₹265 is also not advisable as the bounce from there may not go above ₹350 easily. So, you have to exit the stock now and accept the loss. Having a stop-loss in place is must whenever you enter any trade. That will help you minimise the loss. You can also avoid getting stuck in a wrong position.

Send your queries to techtrail@thehindu.co.in

BANDU'S BLOCKBUSTERS.

On April 1, four years back, piqued by the incessant jokes in the village at his expense, Bandu Barve decided he'd had enough. It was time for him to turn 'smart'. His dead granny's voice rang in his ears — "Read the papers, Bandya, they tell you all." So, off went Bandu to the stash of newspapers on his father's desk. As luck would have it, the first paper Bandu got his hands on was The Hindu businessline. The stock recos, in particular, had him in thrall. Soon Bandu metamorphosed into an ace investor and trader.

These days, Bandu picks five stocks each Sunday, which he believes will be blockbusters over the next week

1 Avenue Supermarts

2 NALCO

3 Carborundum Universal

4 ONGC

5 Adani Power

Last week's prize winner
Ravinder Kumar

Last week's winning stock
Honasa Consumer

Closing price (Mar 27)
₹298.15

Closing price (Apr 2)
₹304.95

Return:
2.28 per cent

Here's your chance to match step with Bandu. Guess the stock that will give the best return by next Friday (BSE prices). By Wednesday noon, mail us your pick and its expected price rise to bandublockbuster@gmail.com with your name, mobile number and address. One lucky winner will get a prize of ₹2,000.

Scan to know the winner selection process

CM YK A CH-CHE

Take 500

Valuation Radar: The Good, The Bad, The Ugly

The Benchmark indices, Sensex and Nifty 50 were down 0.4 and 0.5 per cent respectively last week. BSE IT gained the most by 3 per cent, followed by BSE Metal 2.7 per cent and BSE Capital Goods 1 per cent. BSE Healthcare and BSE Bankex declined by 2.5 and 1.4 per cent respectively last week.

	Nifty 50	Sensex	Auto	Bankex	Capital Goods	Consumer Durables	FMCG	Healthcare	IT	Metal	Oil & Gas	Power	PSU	Reality	Teck
P/E	20.0	20.2	30.9	13.8	49.9	56.5	32.0	36.8	22.1	19.9	8.6	31.8	11.1	32.9	25.4
P/BV	3.1	3.9	5.9	2.1	13.1	14.6	7.1	6.3	6.1	3.2	1.5	4.3	2.2	4.2	7.6
Dividend Yield	1.4	1.2	1.3	1.2	0.5	0.6	1.6	0.6	2.8	1.5	3.0	1.2	2.4	0.5	2.2
Weekly Return (%)	-0.5 ▼	-0.4 ▼	-1.2 ▼	-1.4 ▼	1.0 ▲	-0.7 ▼	0.0 ▼	-2.5 ▼	3.0 ▲	2.7 ▲	0.0 ▼	-0.7 ▼	0.1 ▲	0.3 ▲	1.0 ▲
Monthly Return (%)	-8.7 ▼	-8.6 ▼	-12.5 ▼	-13.8 ▼	-5.2 ▼	-7.8 ▼	-7.9 ▼	-5.4 ▼	-0.4 ▼	-6.6 ▼	-11.4 ▼	-1.5 ▼	-9.0 ▼	-12.6 ▼	-1.9 ▼
Annual Return (%)	-2.7 ▼	-4.3 ▼	11.0 ▲	-1.9 ▼	7.2 ▲	-2.0 ▼	-12.5 ▼	0.6 ▲	-17.8 ▼	23.3 ▲	1.1 ▲	3.3 ▲	10.8 ▲	-21.3 ▼	-11.9 ▼

The sector indices are disseminated by S&P BSE.

Company	CMP	EPS	PE	PB	Year End	Sales Qty	Profit Qty	Sales TTM	Profit TTM	Wkly Rtn	ROCE	DER	Yr-High	Yr-Low
360 ONE [1]	934.8	29.0	32.3	4.1	202512	51.5	18.4	22.1	10.0	-4.4	14.3	0.0	1273.0	766.1
3M India	27967.8	542.7	54.9	15.6	202406	-0.3	21.6	3.0	23.3	-3.6	39.8	0.0	3830.0	2680.1
A B B [2]	6144.7	78.8	78.0	16.6	202512	5.1	-18.3	27.4	39.4	0.6	9.8	0.1	6555.0	4590.1
A B Real Estate	1143.7	-19.0	3.4	202512	-59.8	-389.2	-52.3	-317.9	1.1	-0.2	1.0	2535.0	1080.1	
Aadhar Hig. Fin.	439.7	23.9	18.4	2.8	202512	18.9	22.7	18.7	20.0	-3.5	11.4	2.8	547.8	405.9
Aarti Industries [5]	408.5	10.2	39.9	2.6	202512	25.8	221.7	13.3	1.6	-2.2	6.2	0.7	494.0	338.2
Aarti Industries [5]	115.6	6.6	17.5	1.6	202412	29.9	12.2	25.4	14.2	-2.6	4.6	0.2	238.4	24.6
Abbott India	26275.3	717.3	36.6	13.9	202512	6.8	4.2	9.3	14.2	0.5	45.0	0.0	3592.0	2530.0
ACC	1327.3	134.0	9.9	1.3	202512	8.6	-65.4	16.4	4.7	0.0	17.9	0.0	2123.3	1250.0
ACME Solar Hold. [2]	274.7	8.3	33.2	3.5	202512	42.3	-3.7	61.7	319.0	2.0	7.4	2.8	324.3	172.9
Action Const. Co. [2]	817.2	35.5	23.0	5.5	202512	10.0	24.9	26.3	10.1	3.0	14.0	0.0	1584.0	1041.1
Adani Energy Sol.	942.1	18.7	50.4	4.8	202512	15.1	20.0	4.8	-1.5	10.1	10.2	12	1067.3	745.9
Adani Enterp. [1]	1833.6	25.7	71.4	4.4	202512	8.6	1823.5	-5.1	-15.4	0.6	9.0	1.8	2612.8	1753.5
Adani Green	855.0	10.4	82.6	7.2	202512	7.6	-106.8	14.8	10.1	2.7	9.4	6.4	1179.2	767.0
Adani Ports [2]	1377.3	54.8	25.1	3.8	202512	21.5	24.9	26.3	10.3	14.7	0.0	1584.0	1041.1	
Adani Power [2]	159.9	5.9	26.9	5.3	202512	8.9	18.9	-1.9	12.2	-9.9	21.2	0.7	182.8	94.4
Adani Total Gas [1]	519.8	5.8	89.1	12.7	202512	16.4	11.4	17.7	-3.9	-1.8	17.4	0.4	797.4	453.5
Aditya AMC [5]	917.0	35.3	26.0	7.4	202512	7.4	21.0	12.0	11.8	1.6	35.5	0.0	1044.4	562.5
Aditya Bkr. Fas.	51.7	5.2	6.2	1.1	202512	4.9	-215.9	8.7	4.5	1.1	0.0	1.3	107.7	3.6
Aditya Birla Cap.	298.5	13.5	22.0	2.4	202512	27.4	40.5	13.0	-3.2	-2.4	9.5	4.4	369.3	169.6
Aegis Logistics [1]	589.9	21.9	26.9	3.5	202512	1.1	42.3	7.9	33.1	-3.6	14.5	0.9	946.5	576.0
Aether Industries	1105.7	16.9	65.6	6.3	202512	4.4	46.2	52.7	93.2	-5.6	9.7	0.1	1250.0	723.2
Affcons Infrastr.	285.8	13.9	20.4	1.9	202512	-7.3	5.7	-3.1	-1.9	0.7	14.4	0.6	47.2	265.9
Aiffa [2]	1430.4	31.1	45.9	6.2	202512	19.2	19.1	19.2	19.7	-1.1	16.6	0.1	2186.2	1221.1
AIA Engineering [2]	3678.0	124.8	29.5	4.7	202512	-0.1	14.6	-2.6	10.3	6.7	19.1	0.1	4200.0	3006.6
Ajanta Pharma [2]	2795.1	81.2	34.4	8.1	202512	20.0	17.6	14.8	13.0	-0.9	32.0	0.0	3158.2	2412.1
Akzo Nobel	2584.7	83.0	36.0	6.0	202512	-13.6	12.5	-7.0	12.1	1.4	39.1	0.1	3993.9	2649.1
Ambic BioPharma [2]	329.6	33.8	19.4	2.4	202512	10.8	21.0	13.2	11.6	-2.6	13.1	0.2	1107.8	695.3
Alkem Lab [2]	2297.1	200.9	26.2	4.7	202512	10.7	8.2	11.7	11.0	-1.6	20.0	0.1	5933.0	4627.9
Alkyl Amines [2]	1318.2	35.3	37.3	4.7	202512	-4.6	-3.4	-0.5	1.2	18.2	0.0	2448.8	1212.4	
Allied Blenders [2]	424.0	9.6	44.2	7.6	202512	3.0	19.5	14.0	135.6	6.8	21.0	0.9	720.0	279.9
Allyl Chemicals [1]	12.5	1.5	8.2	1.0	202512	-1.0	-1.7	-0.2	2.1	0.0	0.0	0.0	1.3	0.0
Amara Raja Ener. [1]	727.4	37.4	19.4	1.7	202512	4.2	-22.2	5.1	-26.8	3.7	15.6	0.0	1095.9	671.5
Ambler Enterp.	6281.5	66.0	95.1	6.1	202512	37.9	26.4	30.7	4.6	-4.8	13.5	0.8	8625.0	5404.0
Ambuja Cements [2]	418.3	15.7	26.7	1.8	202512	9.2	89.9	16.4	-8.7	2.3	12.7	0.0	625.0	394.0
Ambuja Pathi Wala [5]	329.6	44.4	7.27	3.9	202512	22.2	21.9	30.8	12.7	8.3	21.7	0.2	1107.8	695.3
Anant Raj [2]	452.0	14.6	30.9	3.0	202512	20.0	30.8	22.6	36.8	3.4	10.9	0.1	744.1	366.2
Angel One [1]	240.8	8.4	28.5	3.8	202512	5.8	-4.6	-14.6	-42.5	2.5	25.8	0.7	328.3	207.0
Apac Inds.	9837.7	246.9	39.8	8.1	202512	16.3	29.8	20.8	22.8	-7.1	36.2	0.1	11641.8	4255.7
Apac Apollo Tubes [2]	499.7	17.6	48.8	1.5	202512	12.5	42.3	-9.2	-2.7	-1.7	11.5	0.1	6487.2	4857.5
Apollo Hospitals [5]	7316.4	126.3	57.9	11.6	202512	17.2	38.8	14.5	38.6	-3.1	17.5	0.6	8099.0	6511.1
Apollo Tyres [2]	409.0	23.0	17.8	1.7	202512	11.8	43.4	6.2	8.3	-0.6	10.9	0.3	540.0	368.0
Apus Value Add. [2]	199.5	17.8	11.2	2.2	202512	23.0	24.0	28.1	25.5	0.8	15.1	1.5	364.9	193.5
Asahi India Glas [1]	118.4	12.3	66.5	5.6	202512	8.4	32.8	5.3	-4.7	0.6	13.1	0.9	1073.0	574.9
Ashtek [2]	148.5	6.2	24.1	6.9	202512	23.6	36.2	13.4	30.1	-0.9	14.3	21.5	58.2	5.0
Ashtek Leyland [1]	2169.4	42.6	51.0	10.6	202512	3.9	5.7	1.3	-6.4	-1.7	24.4	0.1	2985.5	2116.0
Aster DM Health.	658.9	7.0	93.9	8.2	202512	12.9	10.1	8.5	38.5	-1.1	11.6	0.5	73.0	42.9
Asterand [1]	189.4	11.1	17.1	1.1	202512	22.5	21.7	20.8	12.0	0.0	11.1	0.0	176.0	123.0
Astrazeneca Phar [2]	7817.7	83.2	93.9	13.1	202512	38.9	-42.3	34.5	24.1	-1.6	32.9	0.0	10565.1	6501.6
Ather Energy [1]	762.3	-16.9	10.7	10.2	202512	5.0	-140.2	50.9	25.0	-4.3	0.0	1.1	804.4	287.3
Atul	6295.0	201.8	31.2	3.1	202512	11.1	47.8	13.3	42.9	0.9	12.8	0.0	7793.0	4882.0
AU Small Finance	868.1	30.9	28.1	3.6	202512	14.9	26.3	22.3	13.6	-1.7	0.0	0.0	1038.8	498.1
Aurobindo Pharma [1]	139.6	6.8	22.0	2.2	202512	9.0	12.9	8.3	-0.7	1.7	14.2	0.2	135.9	94.4
Autumind Invest [1]	419.9	42.8	9.8	2.2	202512	-22.5	-70.2	-16.0	-9.5	-13.8	29.7	0.1	683.5	271.2
Avenue Super.	4360.0	44.0	99.0	12.4	202512	13.3	18.3	15.4	-5.3	11.5	18.0	0.0	4916.3	3528.7
AWG Agri Busine. [1]	185.6	7.4	24.9	2.4	202512	10.5	-30.0	21.8	-19.5	-1.0	19.8	0.3	291.3	107.2
Axis Bank [2]	1198.2	84.5	14.2	1.8	202512	4.8	4.0	4.5	-6.8	-0.6	0.0	0.0	1418.3	1332.5

BHEL [2]	248.1	2.3	106.1	3.5	202512	16.4	189.8	10.4	56.9	-2.7	3.2	0.4	305.9	193.0	
B ICL [2]	278.4	17.6	48.8	2.7	202512	15.5	15.5	78.3	15.5	15.7	0.5	16.7	0.0	29.0	263.0
Bajaj Auto	8759.6	319.9	27.4	7.2	202512	21.2	27.8	14.8	18.7	-1.6	28.1	0.2	10186.6	7088.3	
Bajaj Finance [1]	842.4	29.3	28.2	5.0	202512	18.4	-2.1	20.7	14.0	-2.1	11.4	3.8	110.25	788.4	
Bajaj Finserv [1]	1640.7	62.1	26.4	3.4	202512	24.9	11.6	15.6	15.9	-3.2	12.4	4.9	2194.7	1598.2	
Bajaj Holdings [2]	891.4	660.2	13.6	1.5	202512	12.7	16.5	15.3	-34.1	-2.2	-1.7	11.5	0.148732	8597.5	
Bajaj Housing	78.0	3.0	26.1	3.1	202512	18.2	23.2	18.9	27.1	2.9	9.5	4.7	137.0	72.6	
Balkrishna Inds [2]	2065.0	67.9	30.4	3.8	202512	6.9	-15.0	2.6	-26.0	-4.0	17.9	0.3	2815.4	2016.0	
Balarampur Chini [1]	488.9	22.2	22.0	2.5	202512	22.0	61.0	15.4	9.0	-1.6	11.1	0.6	627.0	393.4	
Bank of Baroda [2]	146.2	6.3	23.4	1.0	202512	-0.9	-51.8	0.0	59.4	-1.7	0.0	0.0	19.25	134.3	
Bank of India	249.8	37.6	6.6	0.8	202512	3.2	4.4	4.7	-3.9	0.0	0.0	0.0	325.6	212.1	
Bank of Maharashtra [2]	139.3	22.4	6.2	0.8	202512	4.0	6.7	7.9	19.7	-3.9	0.0	0.0	178.5	101.1	
Bank of Maha	64.0	8.4	7.6	1.6	202512	16.1	27.4	19.3	22.9	-0.8	0.0	0.0	77.0	38.1	
BASF India [2]	331.4	14.3	39.3	3.8	202512	61.4	11.1	-39.7	0.4	17.9	0.1	0.0	5418.2	2906.9	
Bata India [5]	657.4	14.9	46.0	2.6	202512	18.8	9.0	23.7	16.2	-0.7	15.0	0.0	1391.0	605.6	
Bayer Crop Sci.	1478.0	149.2	31.9	6.9	202512	4.6	179.8	7.7	28.7	5.9	23.8	0.0	6400.0	4276.9	
BEML Ltd. [1]	4852.5	29.9	49.6	4.4	202512	23.7	-191.7	8.4	-4.8	3.2	11.7	0.1	2437.4	1232.4	
Berger Paints [1]	421.8	9.6	43.8	7.8	202512	0.3	5.1	3.1	-1.7	1.5	24.8	0.1	604.6	391.5	
Bharat Dynamics [5]	1185.8	15.5	75.0	10.3	202512	-31.4	-50.4	57.2	2.5	4.3	10.2	0.0	2096.0	1090.0	
Bharat Electronics [1]	421.5	8.2	51.7	14.3	202512	24.0	20.5	14.5	19.5	-1.1	36.9	0.0	473.3	252.3	
Bharat Forge [2]	1642.4	24.4	67.2	8.4	202512	25.0	41.3	4.5	18.2	-4.8	11.7	0.9	1936.4	91.0	
Bharti Airtel [5]	1789.6	50.4	35.5	9.3	202512	19.6	-12.1	25.0	58.0	-2.9	14.3	2.2	2174.7	1669.6	
Bharti Hexacom [5]	1507.7	35.2	42.8	12.1	202512	4.8	48.7	13.6	67.8	0.2	16.5	1.5	2051.0	1225.0	
Biocon [2]	627.9	10.0	63.1	10.5	202512	11.2	117.6	1	19.4	0.3	11.9	0.0	2020.0	591.6	
Biocon [5]	352.6	5.1	69.8	1.5	202512	9.3	173.6	14.4	5.9	-4.7	6.9	0.8	425.0	225.0	
Birla Corp. [2]	595.1	74.2	12.0	1.1	202512	-4.3	141.6	6.4	151.7	2.3	7.2	0.6	1537.2	773.9	
Birlasoft Ltd. [2]	370.7	17.5	21.2	2.8	202512	-1.1	22.7	-2.6	15.1	10.1	20.8	0.0	437.8	320.0	
Blue Bird International [1]	25.0	16.0	1.1	0.1	202512	17.1	12.9	12.9	4.0	0.0	0.0	0.0	10.0	10.0	
Blue Dart Express [2]	4894.0	122.5	39.1	7.1	202512	6.9	30.1	7.1	5.1	11.1	17.1	0.7	722.2	469.5	
Blue Hm Health [2]	356.9	16.9	21.1	4.9	202512	-39.6	59.4	20.6	25.1	4.0	4.0	10.828	325.2	32.0	
Blue Star [2]	1529.2	26.0	58.8	10.1	202512	4.2	-72.0	9.5	-2.6	-8.7	25.8	0.1	2143.0	1450.0	
Bluebird [2]	212.9	76.3	4.1	0.1	202512	10.0	10.0	9.5	2.5	0.0	0.0	0.0	10.0	10.0	
Brainware Solus [2]	22.41	-3.0	2.5	2.5	202512	11.6	-77.0	12.4	-3.4	0.0	0.0	0.4	438.7	207.1	
Brigade Enterprise [2]	688.3	31.1	22.2	2.6	202512	7.6	-15.1	7.2	17.8	0.0	13.3	1.2	1332.4	615.0	
Britannia Inds [1]	5442.6	100.3	54.3	35.1	202512	9.5	16.9	8.0	11.0	-1.1	51.9	0.4	6337.0	4525.1	

Dhuraivel Gunasekaran
bl. research bureau

With the US-Israel-Iran conflict rattling markets, oil prices rising and risk assets under pressure, fixed income tends to regain appeal. In India, it is still often viewed as a conservative space dominated by bank fixed deposits and small savings schemes. But access is widening through RBI Retail Direct and online bond platforms. Fixed income today is not just about earning interest; returns also depend on how portfolios are positioned across interest-rate cycles and credit risk. Here, we explain the main strategies and what retail investors can take away from them.

ACCRUAL STRATEGY
The accrual strategy is essentially a buy-and-hold approach in bonds. Investors hold securities until maturity to earn steady interest income, much like a bank fixed deposit. It suits those seeking predictable income and capital preservation.

Beyond bank FDs, investors can consider corporate fixed deposits and non-convertible debentures issued by public and private institutions. Returns on these vary with the issuer's credit rating. For instance, a five-year NCD from AAA-rated Power Finance Corporation offered a coupon of 6.85 per cent per annum, while Adani Enterprises, rated AA-, offered around 8.9 per cent for a similar tenure over the last five months.

Government securities are another key option. Issued by the RBI, these include central government bonds, state development loans and treasury bills, and carry minimal default risk. Retail investors can access them through RBI Retail Direct as well as online bond platforms.

Credit quality, however, remains critical in corporate bonds. Investors should generally prefer higher-rated instruments such as AAA and AA+ to reduce default risk.

As bonds are usually held to maturity, this strategy has limited sensitivity to interim rate movements and offers relatively predictable cash flows. But it is not risk-free. Rising rates can lock investors into lower yields, and exiting before maturity may still be difficult or costly.

Within debt mutual funds, overnight, liquid and money market funds are generally closer to accrual-style approach because they aim to limit duration risk and earn carry.

DURATION STRATEGY
The duration strategy involves positioning bond portfolios based on the expected direction of interest rates. As bond prices and yields move inversely, investors prefer longer-duration bonds when rates are expected



Smart strategies in bond investing

DEBT-WISE. Different fixed income approaches suit different goals, risks and market conditions

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KEY RULES

- Higher yields usually mean higher risk
- Longer maturity means bigger interest-rate swings
- Match bond maturity with financial goals

to fall, as these tend to gain more in price. Conversely, when rates are likely to rise, shorter-duration bonds help limit losses.

Unlike accrual investing, this approach relies more on active buying and selling and close tracking of macroeconomic indicators, yield movements and timing decisions. For this reason, it is largely used by institutional investors such as mutual funds.

Retail participation remains limited, though not absent. While platforms such as RBI Retail Direct and online bond platforms provide access, assessing yields and timing trades can be difficult without sufficient expertise. This strategy can deliver capital gains when rates fall, but it also carries higher mark-to-market risk. If interest-rate expectations go wrong, longer-duration bonds can see sharper price declines.

Within debt mutual funds, gilt funds, long duration funds and medium duration funds actively employ duration strategies. In 2024, many such funds extended portfolio maturity on expectations that rates had peaked, helping deliver around 10 per cent one-year returns as of October 31, 2024.

TARGET MATURITY
Target maturity investing involves choosing bonds or funds that mature around a specific year aligned with an investor's goal. Instead of actively trading, the portfolio is held until maturity, allowing investors to lock in

LADDERING STRATEGY
A laddering strategy involves spreading investments across bonds with different maturity periods instead of concentrating on a single tenure. For example, an investor may hold bonds maturing in 1, 3, 5, 7, 10, and 20 years. As each bond matures, the proceeds are reinvested at prevailing interest rates.

This approach reduces the need to time interest rate movements. By investing and reinvesting at different points, it helps smooth out the impact of rate changes over time and provides periodic liquidity. But, it is not risk-free. The strategy still depends on the credit quality of the underlying bonds, and its staggered structure can limit upside in a strong falling-rate cycle.

Some debt mutual funds follow a similar approach in practice, even if they do not explicitly call it laddering. This is commonly seen in corporate bond funds and banking & PSU funds, where investments are spread across maturity buckets. For example, funds such as HDFC Corporate Bond Fund and ICICI Prudential Corporate Bond Fund held bonds maturing over 2 to 7 years during the post-Covid period, especially through the 2022-2023 rate hike cycle, helping balance risk and returns.

BARBELL STRATEGY
The barbell strategy involves investing at two ends of the maturity spectrum, in short-term and long-term bonds, while

largely avoiding the middle segment. Short-term instruments provide liquidity and flexibility, allowing reinvestment if interest rates rise. Long-term bonds, on the other hand, offer higher yields and the potential for capital gains if rates fall.

This approach is often used when the interest rate outlook is uncertain or when the yield curve is steep. It helps balance stability and return potential, making the portfolio both defensive and opportunistic. The trade-off is that the long-end exposure can still make returns volatile, while maintaining the right balance between short and long maturities requires active monitoring. In late 2025, Axis Mutual Fund highlighted the use of a barbell approach in its debt portfolios, allocating to short-term corporate bonds while maintaining selective exposure to long-term debt.

TAKEAWAYS
Retail investors do not need to imitate institutional bond strategies, but they do need to avoid random product selection. Use accrual and target maturity products when income visibility matters. Use duration funds only when you understand interest-rate risk and can tolerate mark-to-market swings. Use laddering when you want staggered liquidity and less interest-rate timing risk. In fixed income, the biggest mistake is reaching for extra yield without understanding the trade-off in credit risk, duration risk or liquidity.

SIMPLYPUT.

Earnings downgrade

Sai Prabhakar Yadavalli
bl. research bureau

Friends Shiv and Jagan stop at a fuel station on their way back home and start discussing the upcoming earnings season. With the ongoing stock price correction, Shiv weighs on the looming risk: earnings downgrade.

Jagan: With Nifty 50 down 13 per cent year-to-date, the markets seem to have factored the worst. Can we start buying now, Mr. Trader?

Shiv: There can be no such blanket calls. But, for me, the bigger risk is the risk of earnings downgrade.

Jagan: The market has factored for weak earnings already; what earnings downgrades are you concerned about?

Shiv: Like you mentioned, 'factoring for weak earnings' implies the valuation multiples have been revised downwards. Currently, the Nifty 50 one year forward

PE has come down from 21 times in January 2026 to 17 times now; that is a 17 per cent decline.

Earnings downgrade implies moving the future expected EPS downwards. This will be the second leg of the revision on top of the multiple revisions and will follow the company commentary in the upcoming results season.

In January, we were working with ₹1,250 of Nifty earnings in next one year and valued it at 21 times. Now, the same earnings are being valued at 17 times. I repeat, the same earnings. What if the earnings estimate for next one year is trimmed to ₹1,150, driven by a gloomy outlook gathered from investor calls; that is the main risk I am worried about.

Jagan: Short-term pain in earnings is expected by investors. Are you pointing to long-term impact?

Shiv: In the midst of such upheaval, investors can digest a quarter or two of



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weak performance. By earnings downgrade, I refer to structural signs of low or weak earnings growth for a prolonged period. This could be led by supply costs. Remember, after Covid, commodities shot up in an unprecedented way, leading to persistent inflation. With oil and gas infrastructure that powers the world falling like dominoes every day, it's hard to tell how long, deep and persistent the aftershocks on oil and gas will be. This can impact

Term insurance premium tracker

For a 30-year-old male/female, non smoker, living in a metro city, Sum assured ₹1 crore with coverage up to 70 yrs

Insurance company	Plan name	Max coverage up to	Max policy term	Annual premium		Claim settlement ratio (%)
		(years)		Male	Female	
Aditya Birla Capital	Super Term Plan	85	55	11,167	9,203	98.4
Bajaj Life	eTouch II	85	55	10,714	8,832	99.3
Canara HSBC Life	Young Term Plan - Life Secure	99	69	11,345	9,477	99.2
HDFC Life	Click 2 Protect Super	85	55	12,390	10,531	99.7
ICICI Prudential	iProtect Smart	99	69	14,462	9,645	99.3
Axis Max Life	Smart Term Plan Plus	85	55	11,217	9,527	99.7
SBI Life	Smart Shield Plus	79	49	13,206	11,109	99.4
TATA AIA Life	Sampoorna Raksha Promise	100	70	11,111	9,429	99.4
Bandhan Life	iTerm Prime	70	40	11,466	9,963	99.7

Claim settlement ratio as per data provided by insurer
Source: www.policybazaar.com, Date: April 03, 2026

Safe Investing • bl • 9

Bank FD interest rates (%)

Bank	<1 year	1 to 2 years	2 to 3 years	3 to 5 years	w.e.f
FOREIGN BANKS					
DBS Bank	6	6.6	6.4	6.4	Mar 25
Deutsche Bank	5	7	6.25	6.25	Jul 25
HSBC	4.1	5.5	5.35	5.5	Jul 17
Standard Chartered	5.75	6.6	6.5	6.5	Aug 29
INDIAN: PUBLIC SECTOR BANKS					
Bank of Maharashtra	5.25	6.65	5.25	5.25	Jan 31
Bank of Baroda	6	6.6	6.5	6.4	Jun 12
Bank of India	5.5	6.6	6.3	6.25	Mar 02
Canara Bank	5.5	6.6	6.25	6.25	Mar 17
Central Bank of India	5	6.2	6.25	6	Dec 10
Indian Bank	4.75	6.6	6.15	6.05	Mar 03
Indian Overseas Bank	5.5	6.6	6.4	6.1	Dec 15
Punjab National Bank	5.6	6.6	6.3	6.1	Feb 24
Punjab & Sind Bank	4.85	6.75	6	5.95	Feb 16
State Bank of India	5.9	6.45	6.4	6.3	Dec 15
UCO Bank	6.3	6.45	6.1	6	Dec 11
Union Bank	6.1	6.6	6.25	6	Feb 11
INDIAN: PRIVATE SECTOR BANKS					
Axis Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.45	Mar 27
Bandhan Bank	4.20	7	7.25	7.25	Mar 25
CSB Bank	6.75	7	6.5	5.75	Sep 10
City Union Bank	6.25	7	6.5	6.25	Mar 11
DCB Bank	6.5	7.15	7.15	7.15	Mar 19
Dhanlaxmi Bank	5.25	6.95	6.25	7	Mar 26
Federal Bank	6	6.7	6.75	6.4	Mar 12
HDFC Bank	5.75	6.45	6.45	6.5	Mar 06
ICICI Bank	5.5	6.3	6.45	6.5	Apr 03
IDBI Bank	5.8	6.45	6.5	6.35	Feb 23
IDFC First Bank	6.5	7.4	7	7	Mar 19
IndusInd Bank	6.25	7	6.9	6.65	Sep 25
J & K Bank	6	6.75	7.25	6.65	Feb 11
Karnataka Bank	5.75	6.65	6.15	6.15	Aug 01
Kotak Bank	6	6.7	6.7	6.4	Feb 11
Karur Vysya Bank	6.65	6.55	6.55	6.55	Sep 26
RBL Bank	6.05	7.2	7.2	7	Sep 24
South Indian Bank	5.9	6.8	6.2	6.2	Mar 21
Tamilnad Mercantile Bank	6.4	7.1	6.6	6.6	Jan 08
TNSC Bank	6.85	7.6	7.1	6.85	NA
Yes Bank	6.5	7	7	7	Mar 05
SMALL FINANCE BANKS					
Equitas Small Finance Bank	6.35	6.9	7.4	7	Mar 02
ESAF Small Finance Bank	4.75	8	7.25	6	Mar 01
Jana Small Finance Bank	7	8	7.5	7.77	Mar 23
Suryoday Small Finance Bank	6.5	7.6	8.1	7.9	29-Mar
Utkarsh Small Finance Bank	6	7.5	7.5	7.25	Dec 01
Ujjivan Small Finance Bank	6	7.45	7.25	7.2	05-Aug

*Data as on respective banks' website on April 03, 2026; For each year range, the maximum offered interest rate is considered; Interest rate is for a normal fixed deposit amount below ₹1 crore. Compiled by BankBazaar.com

ALERTS.

CRED's biometric authentication for UPI payments up to ₹5,000

Fintech platform CRED introduced biometric authentication for UPI payments, allowing members to authorise transactions using face recognition or fingerprint instead of a PIN. It went live on March 25, and is available on iOS and Android devices. The rollout covers transactions up to ₹5,000 and applies across all UPI use cases.

Small Savings Schemes - Interest rates

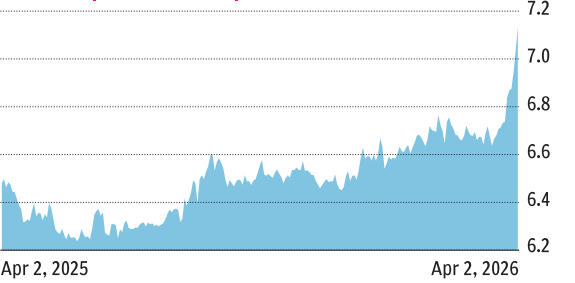
Small Savings Scheme	Interest rate (%)		Compounding frequency
	Jan 1 - Mar 31, 2026	Apr 1 - Jun 30, 2026	
Post Office Savings Deposit	4.0	4.0	Annually
Post Office Time Deposit	1 year	6.9	Quarterly
	2 year	7.0	Quarterly
	3 year	7.1	Quarterly
	5 year	7.5	Quarterly
Post Office Recurring Deposit (5 year)	6.7	6.7	Quarterly
Senior Citizen Savings Scheme	8.2	8.2	Quarterly and paid
Post Office Monthly Income Scheme	7.4	7.4	Monthly and paid
National Savings Certificate	7.7	7.7	Annually
Public Provident Fund	7.1	7.1	Annually
Kisan Vikas Patra	7.5*	7.5*	Annually
Sukanya Samridhi Yojana	8.2	8.2	Annually

Note: Small savings rate as on the latest quarterly reset on March 30, 2026
*Will mature in 115 months Source: Department of Economic Affairs, Ministry of Finance, GoI

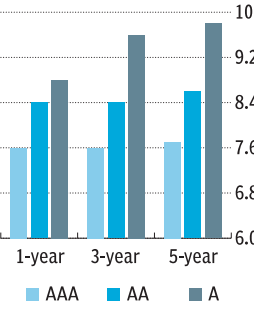
Bond yields

10-year benchmark G-Sec yield (%)

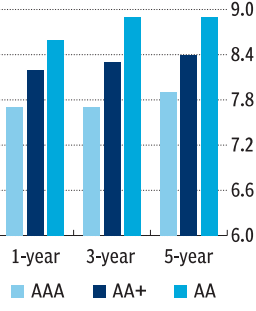
Latest **7.13** | Month-ago **6.68** | Year-ago **6.48**



Corporate bond yields (%)



NBFC bond yields (%)



Yields on government securities of different maturities (%)



Source: Bloomberg (FIMMA data), RBI

Note: All data as on Apr 2, 2026 or latest available



bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
EQUITY - LARGE CAP FUNDS										
*****	Canara Robeco Large Cap	56.6	17104	1.7	0.5	-3.4	11.7	9.7	13.1	0.31
*****	ICICI Pru Large Cap	101.2	77452	1.4	0.9	-1.0	14.4	13.2	13.9	0.46
*****	Nippon Ind Large Cap	83.1	51404	1.5	0.7	0.1	15.4	15.1	14.1	0.50
*****	HDFC Large Cap	1030.9	40085	1.6	1.0	-3.7	11.8	12.1	12.8	0.40
*****	JM Large Cap	139.2	443	2.4	0.9	-2.3	12.1	10.8	10.6	0.33
*****	Kotak Large Cap	523.5	10925	1.7	0.6	-0.7	12.1	10.5	12.2	0.33
*****	SBI Large Cap	85.2	55246	1.5	0.8	-0.7	11.3	10.2	11.8	0.33
***	Aditya Birla SL Large Cap	475.3	30094	1.6	1.0	-2.1	12.0	10.8	11.8	0.34
***	Bandhan Large Cap	70.7	2024	2.0	0.9	0.1	13.9	11.0	12.2	0.33
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Large Cap	201.6	2639	2.0	0.8	-2.0	12.7	11.1	12.3	0.35
***	Edelweiss Large Cap	76.7	1477	2.1	0.6	-2.0	11.6	10.6	12.3	0.33
***	Franklin Ind Large Cap	935.5	6750	1.9	1.1	-1.2	11.6	9.1	10.5	0.28
***	Invesco India Largecap	62.5	1702	2.0	0.7	-0.5	13.9	11.8	12.1	0.35
***	Mirae Asset Large Cap	101.9	40184	1.5	0.6	-2.1	9.9	9.0	12.6	0.27
***	Tata Large Cap	459.9	2784	2.0	1.0	-2.0	11.9	10.7	11.4	0.34
***	UTI Large Cap	245.2	12658	1.8	0.9	-4.1	9.7	8.5	11.2	0.25
**	DSP Large Cap	427.7	7270	1.8	0.9	-4.0	14.4	10.8	11.3	0.37
***	HSBC Large Cap	438.5	1894	2.1	1.3	-0.2	12.2	9.8	12.0	0.28
**	LIC MF Large Cap	49.3	1422	2.2	1.1	-4.6	8.5	7.6	10.1	0.21
**	Union Largecap	21.3	453	2.5	1.7	-3.1	9.8	9.0	-	0.27
**	Axis Large Cap	54.5	32437	1.6	0.7	-4.1	9.6	6.9	11.6	0.18
*	Groww Largecap	39.5	132	2.5	1.3	1.1	11.4	9.5	10.9	0.27
*	PGIM India Large Cap	302.7	568	2.4	0.8	-4.3	7.8	7.2	9.7	0.20
*	Mahi Manu Large Cap	20.9	737	2.3	0.8	-3.1	11.2	9.6	-	0.29
-	Taurus Large Cap	146.6	51	2.6	2.3	0.3	14.3	10.6	10.0	0.31
EQUITY - LARGE & MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Bandhan Large & Mid Cap	125.5	14780	1.7	0.5	3.0	20.7	16.9	15.6	0.53
*****	HDFC Large and Mid Cap	304.8	28580	1.6	0.9	-1.4	16.6	15.5	14.1	0.49
*****	ICICI Pru Large & Mid Cap	940.0	28506	1.6	0.8	1.7	18.2	17.7	15.1	0.62
*****	Axis Large & Mid Cap	30.0	15559	1.7	0.6	1.6	17.0	13.3	-	0.38
*****	Quant Large & Mid Cap	101.6	3070	2.0	0.8	-6.8	13.7	14.1	14.9	0.40
*****	SBI Large & Midcap	585.8	38766	1.6	0.7	2.9	15.0	15.0	14.6	0.52
*****	UTI Large & Mid Cap	168.4	5724	1.8	0.9	2.6	19.4	16.1	13.9	0.53
***	BOI Large & Mid Cap Equity	83.7	456	2.3	1.1	4.1	15.2	13.7	12.6	0.41
***	Canara Robeco Large and Mid Cap	224.6	24731	1.6	0.6	-4.6	13.1	11.4	14.7	0.34
***	DSP Large & Mid Cap	566.5	18253	1.7	0.6	-1.8	17.2	13.7	14.6	0.44
***	Edelweiss Large & Mid Cap	80.5	4485	1.8	0.4	2.1	16.0	13.1	14.1	0.41
***	Invesco India Large & Mid Cap	88.4	9392	1.8	0.6	0.9	20.5	14.9	15.0	0.42
***	Kotak Large & Midcap	317.5	30712	1.6	0.6	2.8	16.0	13.9	15.1	0.46
***	Mirae Asset Large & Midcap	138.6	42943	1.5	0.6	2.3	14.4	11.8	16.6	0.34
***	Nippon Ind Vision Large & Mid Cap	1334.2	6963	1.9	1.1	-0.7	17.5	14.5	12.4	0.46
**	Franklin Ind Large & Mid Cap	171.0	3464	2.0	1.3	-0.8	13.7	11.4	11.1	0.34
**	LIC MF Large & Midcap	37.4	3065	1.9	0.6	-3.3	15.2	12.2	14.1	0.37
**	Sundaram Large and Mid Cap	77.7	6868	1.8	0.7	-0.7	13.9	11.9	13.6	0.35
**	Tata Large & Mid Cap	442.5	8143	1.8	0.7	-9.9	8.5	9.1	11.9	0.29
*	Aditya Birla SL Large & Mid Cap	825.7	5761	1.9	1.1	0.5	12.7	8.5	11.3	0.21
*	Navi Large & Midcap	31.6	307	2.3	0.5	-3.0	10.0	10.3	12.3	0.30
-	HSBC Large & Mid Cap	25.0	4706	1.9	0.8	5.5	17.6	13.7	-	0.34
EQUITY - FLEXI CAP FUNDS										
*****	HDFC Flexi Cap	1848.1	100455	1.3	0.7	0.4	18.1	17.9	16.0	0.63
*****	JM Flexicap	84.8	5159	1.8	0.7	-6.8	16.2	14.6	15.7	0.44
*****	Parag Parikh Flexi Cap	79.0	134253	1.3	0.6	1.0	16.8	15.5	16.7	0.60
*****	Edelweiss Flexi Cap	35.1	3203	1.9	0.4	0.9	15.4	13.1	14.1	0.40
*****	Franklin Ind Flexi Cap	1472.8	19598	1.7	0.9	-2.9	15.0	13.6	13.1	0.42
*****	PGIM India Flexi Cap	32.5	6004	1.8	0.5	-2.3	9.7	9.5	13.2	0.28
*****	Union Flexi Cap	45.9	2349	2.0	0.9	-1.9	12.5	11.1	12.5	0.33
***	Aditya Birla SL Flexi Cap	1686.1	25207	1.7	0.9	2.6	15.7	12.2	13.8	0.37
***	Bandhan Flexi Cap	190.2	7427	1.9	1.1	0.1	13.4	10.9	10.8	0.33
***	Canara Robeco Flexi Cap	307.4	13390	1.7	0.6	-0.2	12.3	10.6	13.6	0.33
***	DSP Flexi Cap	92.1	12165	1.7	0.7	-3.2	13.9	10.6	13.6	0.31
***	HSBC Flexi Cap	196.9	5279	1.9	1.2	-0.3	15.5	12.7	12.4	0.35
***	Kotak Flexicap	78.2	56853	1.5	0.6	1.9	13.8	11.4	13.5	0.35
***	SBI Flexicap	98.9	23297	1.7	0.8	-1.9	10.2	9.2	11.7	0.28
***	Tata Flexi Cap	21.9	3699	1.9	0.6	-1.5	13.5	10.1	-	0.31
**	Axis Flexi Cap	23.9	12871	1.7	0.7	-1.7	12.5	8.8	-	0.23
**	Motilal Oswal Flexi Cap	51.2	12890	1.7	0.8	-8.5	18.7	10.4	12.2	0.27
**	Navi Flexi Cap	23.3	261	2.2	0.6	2.4	10.9	10.3	-	0.31
**	UTI Flexi Cap	275.4	22886	1.7	1.1	-8.2	7.7	5.1	11.1	0.11
*	LIC MF Flexi Cap	88.8	1000	2.3	1.6	0.7	11.6	9.0	9.4	0.25
*	Shriram Flexi Cap	18.1	131	2.4	0.5	-4.6	8.2	7.5	-	0.18
*	Taurus Flexi Cap	201.1	346	2.7	2.6	-4.5	12.4	9.7	9.3	0.28
-	Quant Flexi Cap	89.7	6354	1.9	0.7	-1.8	14.8	17.3	18.2	0.48
EQUITY - MULTI CAP FUNDS										
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Multi Cap	256.5	3096	2.0	0.9	-2.3	15.5	14.2	13.6	0.40
-	ICICI Pru Multicap	731.3	16315	1.7	0.9	-0.5	17.1	15.1	14.2	0.49
-	Invesco India Multicap	110.1	4001	1.9	0.7	-8.2	13.1	11.8	12.8	0.33
-	Mahi Manu Multi Cap	32.8	6174	1.8	0.5	2.7	17.7	15.9	-	0.45
-	Nippon Ind Multi Cap	272.0	50820	1.5	0.7	1.3	18.6	18.9	15.1	0.59
-	Quant Multi Cap	552.6	7274	1.8	0.7	-5.8	10.2	12.5	16.2	0.33
-	Sundaram Multi Cap	340.1	2827	2.0	0.9	-1.7	14.3	13.3	14.2	0.40
EQUITY - MID CAP FUNDS										
*****	Edelweiss Mid Cap	93.2	14355	1.7	0.5	4.0	22.2	18.6	17.7	0.54
*****	HDFC Mid Cap	182.8	94257	1.4	0.8	5.9	22.3	19.7	17.5	0.64
*****	Quant Mid Cap	191.4	7341	1.8	0.9	-6.7	14.5	17.2	15.7	0.48
*****	Invesco India Midcap	159.7	10772	1.7	0.5	4.0	23.1	18.0	17.4	0.49
*****	Mahi Manu Mid Cap	31.2	4440	1.9	0.6	3.2	21.7	17.9	-	0.53
*****	Motilal Oswal Midcap	83.3	33689	1.6	0.8	-10.4	19.0	20.4	15.9	0.52
*****	Nippon Ind Growth Mid Cap	3880.4	43983	1.5	0.7	4.7	23.0	19.6	18.2	0.59
***	Axis Midcap	104.0	31977	1.6	0.6	3.0	17.3	13.6	16.2	0.40
***	Baroda BNP Paribas Mid Cap	96.6	2341	2.0	0.5	5.1	18.6	15.4	15.2	0.47
***	ICICI Pru Midcap	291.8	7280	1.9	1.0	12.7	22.8	17.8	16.1	0.54
***	Kotak Midcap	124.1	61694	1.4	0.4	5.6	18.6	16.5	17.3	0.49
***	PGIM India Midcap	56.8	10877	1.7	0.5	-2.7	10.8	12.3	14.9	0.37
***	SBI Midcap	210.4	23154	1.7	0.9	-3.9	13.8	14.2	13.7	0.45
***	Sundaram Mid Cap	1292.4	13235	1.7	0.9	4.5	21.8	17.3	14.7	0.51
***	Tata Mid Cap	404.4	5505	1.8	0.6	3.7	18.9	15.4	15.6	0.47
**	Aditya Birla SL Midcap	708.0	6130	1.9	1.0	-0.4	17.6	14.8	13.1	0.43
**	Franklin Ind Mid Cap	2433.0	12328	1.8	1.0	-3.1	18.1	14.0	14.1	0.40
**	Taurus Mid Cap	106.5	123	2.5	1.9	-2.3	14.0	11.6	14.3	0.31
**	UTI Mid Cap	270.7	11734	1.8	0.9	1.0	14.9	12.7	13.6	0.37
**	DSP Midcap	134.5	19641	1.7	0.7	3.5	17.7	11.7	14.3	0.34
*	HSBC Midcap	371.4	12448	1.7	0.7	9.8	22.4	16.0	16.1	0.42
*	LIC MF Midcap	25.7	337	2.5	1.4	-2.8	17.6	12.4	-	0.33
EQUITY - SMALL CAP FUNDS										
*****	Nippon Ind Small Cap	150.9	67642	1.4	0.7	-0.1	18.3	20.2	19.9	0.54
*****	Quant Small Cap	226.9	27654	1.7	0.8	-1.5	18.0	21.6	17.5	0.53
*****	AXIS Small Cap	95.0	26008	1.6	0.6	-0.9	15.4	16.5	17.4	0.50

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr.)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				Sortino Ratio (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	10 Year CAGR	
*****	Bank of India Small Cap	41.8	1904	2.0	0.5	-0.5	17.7	17.6	-	0.43
*****	Invesco India Smallcap	37.5	9716	1.7	0.4	2.0	20.9	19.2	-	0.50
***	DSP Small Cap	181.1	16886	1.7	0.8	6.1	18.6	17.6	16.0	0.46
***	HDFC Small Cap	122.2	37424	1.6	0.7	0.3	15.3	17.8	17.0	0.49
***	ICICI Pru Smallcap	77.2	8355	1.8	0.8	-0.5	13.6	16.0	15.2	0.49
***	Kotak Small Cap	224.1	16871	1.7	0.6	-5.1	12.5	13.1	15.7	0.36
***	Sundaram Small Cap	235.1	3306	1.9	0.8	4.1	17.3	17.0	13.9	0.43
***	Tata Small Cap	31.7	10715	1.7	0.4	-13.4	10.6	15.5	-	0.41
***	Union Small Cap	45.8	1787	2.1	1.0	6.9	17.8	16.4	15.0	0.42
**	Franklin Ind Small Cap	149.5	12934	1.8	0.9	-2.4	15.7	17.1	14.6	0.44
**	HSBC Small Cap	69.5	15375	1.7	0.7	-4.8	13.7	17.9	17.2	0.43
**	SBI Small Cap	151.0	34932	1.6	0.8	-4.5	11.6	13.3	17.0	0.39

bl. rating

Scheme Name

Latest NAV
(₹)

Latest Corpus
(₹ Cr)

Expense Ratio (%)

Regular

Direct

Trailing Returns (%)

1 Month
*Ann

3 Month
*Ann

6 Month
*Ann

1 Year
CAGR

AA & Below

CASH FUNDS

LIQUID FUNDS

- 360 ONE Liquid

2099.8

1283

0.3

0.2

7.3

6.3

6.0

6.0

-

- Aditya Birla SL Liquid

440.0

51838

0.4

0.2

7.5

6.5

6.2

6.2

-

- Axis Liquid

3042.0

43636

0.2

0.1

7.6

6.5

6.2

6.2

-

- Bandhan Liquid

3297.3

12083

0.2

0.1

7.5

6.4

6.1

6.1

-

- Bank of India Liquid

3147.0

1915

0.1

0.1

7.4

6.5

6.2

6.3

-

- Baroda BNP Paribas Liquid

3139.2

12362

0.3

0.1

7.3

6.4

6.1

6.1

-

- Canara Robeco Liquid

3287.7

7457

0.2

0.1

7.6

6.4

6.1

6.2

-

- DSP Liquidity

3899.5

21058

0.2

0.1

7.6

6.5

6.2

6.3

-

- Edelweiss Liquid

3493.8

10631

0.2

0.1

7.5

6.4

6.2

6.2

-

- Groww Liquid

2641.6

164

0.2

0.1

7.6

6.5

6.2

6.2

-

- HDFC Liquid

3538.0

67850

0.3

0.2

7.6

6.5

6.2

6.2

-

- HSBC Liquid

2723.2

17735

0.2

0.1

7.6

6.4

6.1

6.2

-

- ICICI Pru Liquid

404.2

53738

0.3

0.2

7.4

6.4

6.1

6.2

-

- Invesco India Liquid

3753.9

15423

0.2

0.2

7.5

6.5

6.1

6.2

-

- ITI Liquid

1421.0

58

0.3

0.1

6.9

6.0

5.8

6.0

-

- JM Liquid

74.5

2577

0.3

0.2

7.1

6.3

6.0

6.1

-

- Kotak Liquid

5518.7

42746

0.3

0.2

7.5

6.4

6.1

6.2

-

- LIC MF Liquid

4937.5

14187

0.2

0.1

7.7

6.5

6.2

6.2

-

- Mahi Manu Liquid

1777.4

1145

0.3

0.2

7.3

6.4

6.1

6.2

-

- Mirae Asset Liquid

2862.5

10562

0.2

0.1

7.3

6.3

6.1

6.2

-

- Motilal Oswal Liquid

14.4

1114

0.4

0.2

6.8

6.0

5.8

5.8

-

- Navi Liquid

29.6

84

0.2

0.2

6.3

5.7

5.6

5.8

-

- Nippon Ind Liquid

6665.6

32736

0.3

0.2

7.5

6.4

6.1

6.2

-

- Parag Parikh Liquid

1514.3

5098

0.2

0.1

7.4

6.4

6.1

6.1

-

- PGIM India Liquid

355.6

478

0.2

0.1

7.7

6.5

6.1

6.2

5.20

- Quantum Liquid

43.1

1418

0.5

0.2

6.3

5.9

5.7

5.9

-

- Quant Liquid

36.5

510

0.3

0.2

6.3

5.8

5.7

5.8

-

- SBI Liquid

4267.4

66119

0.3

0.2

7.6

6.4

6.1

6.1

-

- Sundaram Liquid

2407.0

6221

0.4

0.1

7.4

6.3

6.0

6.1

-

- Tata Liquid

4301.7

33551

0.3

0.2

7.4

6.4

6.1

6.2

-

- Union Liquid

2628.4

5756

0.2

0.1

7.3

6.4

6.1

6.2

-

- UTI Liquid

4482.3

27263

0.2

0.1

7.7

6.5

6.2

6.2

-

- WhiteOak Capital Liquid

1467.6

600

0.3

0.2

7.5

6.4

6.0

6.1

-

ARBITRAGE FUNDS										
-	Aditya Birla SL Arbitrage	27.7	26792	1.0	0.3	5.4	6.0	6.1	6.1	-
-	Axis Arbitrage	19.5	9212	1.0	0.3	5.6	6.2	6.2	6.0	-
-	Bandhan Arbitrage	33.8	8650	1.1	0.4	5.4	5.8	5.9	5.8	-
-	Bank of India Arbitrage	14.4	49	0.9	0.4	5.2	6.0	6.0	5.7	-
-	Baroda BNP Paribas Arbitrage	16.7	1362	1.1	0.3	5.4	5.7	5.8	5.8	0.00
-	DSP Arbitrage	15.6	6923	1.0	0.4	5.6	6.0	6.1	5.9	-
-	Edelweiss Arbitrage	20.2	15452	1.1	0.4	6.1	6.2	6.2	6.0	-
-	HDFC Arbitrage	32.0	24768	0.9	0.4	5.8	6.1	6.2	6.1	-
-	HSBC Arbitrage	19.8	2433	0.9	0.3	6.7	6.4	6.3	6.1	-
-	ICICI Pru Equity-Arbitrage	33.8	32989	0.9	0.4	5.7	6.2	6.2	6.1	-
-	Invesco India Arbitrage	35.4	28527	1.1	0.4	5.6	6.1	6.3	6.1	-
-	ITI Arbitrage	13.6	49	0.9	0.2	7.7	7.0	6.7	6.4	-
-	JM Arbitrage	34.0	355	1.1	0.4	5.7	5.9	6.0	5.7	-
-	Kotak Arbitrage	39.2	71265	1.0	0.4	6.2	6.4	6.3	6.1	-
-	LIC MF Arbitrage	14.4	277	1.0	0.3	6.4	6.3	6.1	5.9	-
-	Mahi Manu Arbitrage	12.8	98	1.1	0.4	4.9	5.4	5.8	5.4	-
-	Mirae Asset Arbitrage	13.6	3834	0.9	0.2	5.4	6.2	6.1	5.9	-
-	Nippon Ind Arbitrage	27.7	16515	1.0	0.3	5.6	6.1	6.2	6.0	1.70
-	PGIM India Arbitrage	19.1	105	1.0	0.4	6.4	6.2	5.9	5.7	-
-	SBI Arbitrage Opport	35.4	44393	0.9	0.4	6.3	6.4	6.3	6.2	-
-	Sundaram Arbitrage	15.1	335	1.0	0.3	5.6	6.3	6.1	6.0	-
-	Tata Arbitrage	15.0	21327	1.1	0.3	6.4	6.2	6.2	6.1	-
-	Union Arbitrage	14.6	276	1.0	0.4	6.3	6.1	6.0	5.8	-
-	UTI Arbitrage	36.6	11070	0.8	0.3	5.5	6.1	6.3	6.2	-

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below (%)
				Regular	Direct	1 Year	2 Year	3 Year	5 Year	
						CAGR	CAGR	CAGR	CAGR	
DEBT FUNDS										
DEBT - ULTRA SHORT DURATION FUNDS										
*****	Aditya Birla SL Savings	573.9	21467	0.6	0.3	6.6	7.2	7.3	6.3	9.89
*****	Baroda BNPP Ultra Short Duration	1611.3	670	0.5	0.3	6.3	6.9	7.1	6.1	2.25
*****	Nippon Ind Ultra Short Duration	4206.9	10672	1.1	0.4	6.2	6.7	6.8	6.7	28.54
*****	Bandhan Ultra Short Duration	15.9	3528	0.5	0.3	6.3	6.9	7.0	5.9	-
*****	ICICI Pru Ultra Short Term	29.0	16816	0.8	0.4	6.5	7.0	7.0	6.1	10.98
*****	Mirae Asset Ultra Short Duration	1367.5	1640	0.5	0.1	6.4	7.1	7.2	6.1	1.22
*****	UTI Ultra Short Duration	4417.7	3946	1.0	0.3	5.9	6.6	6.7	6.3	10.88
*****	Axis Ultra Short Duration	15.4	5824	1.2	0.4	5.9	6.5	6.6	5.6	8.95
*****	DSP Ultra Short	3546.1	3714	1.0	0.3	5.8	6.5	6.6	5.5	10.16
*****	HDFC Ultra Short Term	15.8	17171	0.7	0.4	6.2	6.9	7.0	6.0	4.22
*****	HSBC Ultra Short Duration	1415.4	2874	0.3	0.2	6.4	6.9	7.0	6.0	-
*****	Invesco India Ultra Short Duration	2813.0	1292	0.8	0.2	6.1	6.7	6.9	5.7	11.55
*****	Kotak Savings	44.8	16105	0.8	0.4	6.2	6.8	6.9	5.8	8.20
*****	Mahi Manu Ultra Short Duration	1435.7	217	0.7	0.3	6.1	6.8	6.9	5.8	4.38
*****	SBI Ultra Short Duration	6245.6	13685	0.6	0.4	6.4	6.9	7.0	5.9	8.23
*****	WhiteOak Capital Ultra Short Dur	1415.8	541	1.0	0.5	5.6	6.3	6.4	5.5	-
*****	BOI Ultra Short Duration	3295.7	165	0.9	0.3	5.9	6.4	6.4	5.5	6.68
*****	LIC MF Ultra Short Duration	1375.9	230	1.2	0.2	5.8	6.4	6.3	5.4	2.32
*****	PGIM India Ultra Short Duration	35.4	161	0.9	0.4	5.6	6.3	6.4	5.5	-
*****	Tata Ultra Short Term	14.8	3793	1.2	0.3	5.9	6.5	6.6	5.6	12.54
*	Canara Robeco Ultra Short Term	3953.8	563	1.0	0.4	5.8	6.4	6.4	5.4	-
*	Motilal Oswal Ultra Short Term	17.1	441	1.0	0.2	5.2	5.5	5.7	4.8	-
*	Sundaram Ultra Short Duration	2784.0	1907	1.4	0.2	5.2	5.9	6.0	5.0	1.63

DEBT - LOW DURATION FUNDS										
*****	ICICI Pru Savings	569.1	31284	0.6	0.4	6.7	7.4	7.5	6.5	7.25
*****	UTI Low Duration	3706.1	2990	0.4	0.3	6.4	7.2	7.2	7.2	5.72
*****	Axis Treasury Advantage	3229.7	7831	0.7	0.3	6.4	7.1	7.2	6.1	7.92
*****	DSP Low Duration	20.6	5593	0.6	0.3	5.9	6.8	6.9	5.9	-
*****	HDFC Low Duration	60.2	25582	1.1	0.5	6.1	6.8	7.0	6.0	11.02
*****	HSBC Low Duration	29.9	1009	0.9	0.4	7.4	7.6	7.5	6.1	12.61
*****	Aditya Birla SL Low Duration	682.9	15209	1.2	0.4	5.9	6.6	6.7	5.8	10.10
*****	Bandhan Low Duration	40.2	5723	0.7	0.3	6.0	6.8	6.9	5.8	-
*****	Canara Robeco Savings	43.9	1350	0.5	0.2	6.1	6.8	7.0	5.8	-
*****	Invesco India Low Duration	3941.3	2065	0.7	0.3	6.1	6.8	7.0	5.8	8.36
*****	JM Low Duration	38.6	222	0.9	0.4	6.0	6.8	6.8	5.7	5.62
*****	Nippon Ind Low Duration	3899.7	10969	1.0	0.4	6.1	6.8	6.9	5.9	8.89
*****	SBI Low Duration	3632.4	16391	1.0	0.4	5.9	6.7	6.8	5.7	1.71
*****	Tata Treasury Advantage	4094.7	3491	0.6	0.2	6.1	6.8	6.9	5.9	3.00
*****	Kotak Low Duration	3480.8	16393	1.2	0.4	6.0	6.8	6.8	5.8	10.70
*****	Mahi Manu Low Duration	1699.6	573	1.1	0.3	5.8	6.6	6.7	5.6	15.12
*****	Mirae Asset Low Duration	2349.5	2333	0.9	0.2	5.9	6.7	6.8	5.7	8.86
*****	Sundaram Low Duration	3589.7	470	1.2	0.4	5.5	6.5	6.6	5.6	2.77
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Low Duration	41.7	301	1.0	0.3	5.8	6.5	6.6	5.6	5.02
*****	LIC MF Low Duration	41.1	2018	1.2	0.3	5.8	6.5	6.6	5.6	2.58

DEBT - MONEY MARKET FUNDS										
*****	Nippon Ind Money Market	4340.1	21876	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.1	7.3	6.3	-
*****	UTI Money Market	3226.8	20320	0.2	0.1	6.5	7.2	7.3	6.3	-
*****	Aditya Birla SL Money Manager	386.9	30778	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.1	7.3	6.3	-
*****	Axis Money Market	1496.9	23790	0.3	0.2	6.5	7.2	7.3	6.3	-
*****	ICICI Pru Money Market	396.9	35305	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.1	7.3	6.2	-
*****	Kotak Money Market	4697.7	33661	0.4	0.2	6.5	7.1	7.3	6.3	-
*****	Baroda BNP Paribas Money Market	1440.8	4965	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.0	7.0	5.8	-
*****	Franklin Ind Money Market	52.5	4352	0.3	0.1	6.5	7.1	7.3	6.1	-
*****	HDFC Money Market	5977.7	33094	0.5	0.2	6.4	7.1	7.2	6.2	-
*****	PGIM India Money Market	1384.6	152	0.5	0.2	6.2	6.8	6.9	5.8	-
*****	Sundaram Money Market	15.7	2334	0.3	0.2	6.4	7.0	7.1	6.1	-
*****	Tata Money Market	4939.1	36819	0.4	0.2	6.4	7.1	7.3	6.3	-
*****	DSP Savings	55.0	8549	0.4	0.2	6.2	6.8	7.0	5.9	-

bl. rating	Scheme Name	Latest NAV (₹)	Latest Corpus (₹ Cr)	Expense Ratio (%)		Trailing Returns (%)				AA & Below
				Regular	Direct	1 Year CAGR	2 Year CAGR	3 Year CAGR	5 Year CAGR	
*****	HSBC Money Market	27.6	5379	0.3	0.2	6.3	7.0	7.1	5.8	-

LPG under-recoveries: OMCs to get ₹17,500 crore via 7 tranches in FY27

FISCAL RELIEF. A ₹30,000 cr compensation was approved in Aug 2025 for under-recoveries, projected losses

Rishi Ranjan Kala
New Delhi

The Oil Ministry has informed the Parliamentary Standing Committee on Petroleum and Natural Gas that it will release the remaining ₹17,500 crore compensation to oil marketing companies (OMCs) on LPG under-recoveries in seven equal tranches during the current financial year ending March 2027.

In August 2025, the Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas had announced a compensation of ₹30,000 crore for the three OMCs — Indian Oil Corporation (IOCL), Bharat Petroleum Corporation (BPCL) and Hindustan Petroleum Corporation (HPCL — for under-recoveries on liquefied petroleum gas.

The under-recoveries on domestic LPG (negative buffer balance) of the OMCs stood at ₹41,267 crore as on March 31, 2025. In view of the accumulated under-recoveries and the projected losses up to March 31, 2026, the government approved compensation of ₹30,000 crore in August 2025, to be released in 12 equal tranches commencing November 2025, the Ministry told the panel.

“Accordingly, during FY26, five tranches aggregating ₹12,500 crore are being released, while the balance amount of ₹17,500 crore will be released in FY27 in the remaining seven tranches,” it added.

Since the Cabinet, while approving the compensation package of ₹30,000 crore, stipulated a 12-tranche disbursement arrangement, the



COST BURDEN. Cumulatively, the OMCs incurred under-recoveries of around ₹41,700 crore in FY25, which amount to roughly ₹220 per 14.2 kg cylinder **VELANKANNI RAJ B**

Budget provisions for FY26 and FY27 have been scheduled accordingly,” the Ministry said.

In August last year, the government approved a ₹30,000 crore compensation for LPG under-recoveries in FY25 and ₹12,000 crore as subsidy to continue providing Ujjwala consumers with affordable LPG cylinders in FY26.

Cumulatively, the OMCs incurred under-recoveries of around ₹41,700 crore in FY25, which amount to roughly ₹220 per 14.2 kg cylinder. The total LPG under-recovery reached around

₹49,210 crore by June 30, 2025.

PRICE HIKE
On April 1, 2026, the Oil Ministry after increasing the prices of commercial LPG said that the hike is due to a 44 per cent surge in the Saudi Contract Price from \$542 per tonne in March 2026 to \$780 for April, as 20-30 per cent of global LPG supplies are stuck in Strait of Hormuz.

“At current prices, OMCs are incurring under-recovery of ₹380 per cylinder. Cumulative losses by end-May will reach approximately ₹40,484 crore. Last year also, out of total losses of ₹60,000 crore, ₹30,000 crore was absorbed by Oil PSUs and ₹30,000 crore by the Centre in order to insulate the citizen from high international LPG prices,” the Ministry had said.

‘Phygital’ Economy to drive India’s growth, says MeitY Secretary



S Vaidhyasubramaniam (second from right), Vice-Chancellor of SASTRA, after signing MoUs, in the presence of S Krishnan (centre), Secretary, MeitY.

Our Bureau
Chennai

“A good blend of digital and physical infrastructure with skilling is essential to achieve India’s target to become the third largest economy by 2030” said S Krishnan, Secretary, Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology.

Citing a study done by ICRIER, Krishnan highlighted the accelerated growth of digital economy, which is expected to be 20 per cent of India’s total economy by 2030, from 12 per cent in 2021-22.

The MeitY Secretary was inaugurating SASTRA’s facilities comprising Electronics Manufacturing, Firmware Development, E-Mobility, and Semiconductor Testing and Packaging Assembly Line.

As part of this, Bajaj Auto has established the Bajaj Engineering Skill Training Cen-

Citing a study done by ICRIER, Krishnan highlighted that India’s digital economy is projected to grow to 20% by 2030

ter towards capacity building in the above areas.

Tata Electronics and Caliber Interconnects signed an MoU with SASTRA to offer Electronic Manufacturing programmes with a strong industry internship module.

Speaking about the electronics sector, Krishnan said that the push towards electronics component manufacturing has also resulted in exports touching almost \$40 billion in FY25 with a potential for Electronics Manufacturing and IT/IES market hitting \$1 trillion by 2030.

TN’s plastics MSMEs face 50% output cut as polymer prices soar amid W. Asia war

Our Bureau
Chennai

MSME plastic manufacturers in Tamil Nadu and Pondicherry are reporting a near 50 per cent cut in production as prices of key raw materials soar and shortages persist as the US-Iran war rages.

In March alone, prices of polymers (which are largely derived from crude oil and natural gas) rose by around 70 per cent, disrupting operations and killing demand for over 8,000 MSMEs across TN and Pondicherry, G Sankaran, President, Tamil Nadu, Pondy Plastic Association (‘TANPPA’), told *businessline*.

Over 2 lakh people are directly employed in these MSMEs, he ad-

ded, noting that creation of “artificial scarcity” and hoarding by polymer manufacturers were leading to this situation.

Earlier in March, Arvind M Mehta, Chairman of the All India Plastics Manufacturers Association, had also said at an event that the industry has an inventory of 15-20 days, and the rise in costs is being passed on to end consumers through marginal price hikes, but if the war prolongs, this may be a real challenge.

SEEKS CENTRE’S SUPPORT
Making a set of demands to the Central government to help tackle this situation, the TANPPA requested that major plastic raw material manufacturing companies supply raw materials directly to plastic

product manufacturers through authorised stockists located in key cities, rather than selling in bulk to traders and intermediaries. “To prevent artificial scarcity and price manipulation, direct supply to manufacturers is essential,” it said.

The government should also introduce a price control mechanism for plastic raw materials similar to that in force for petrol and diesel, the Association said.

Further, priority should be given to small and micro manufacturing units that purchase less than 20 tonnes per month, their list of demands adds.

In another key request, the industry body asked that the 18 per cent GST imposed on waste plastic and recycled plastic products be fully exempted.

Pharma exports grew 5.6% to \$28 billion in April-February FY26: Pharmexcil

Our Bureau
Hyderabad

India’s pharmaceutical exports totalled \$28.29 billion during April-February of FY26, registering a 5.6 per cent growth compared to the same period of the previous financial year, according to Pharmaceuticals Exports Promotion Council (Pharmexcil).

Speaking at the inaugural session of ‘Chintan Shivir 2026: Scaling Up Pharma Exports’ organised by the Council here on Saturday, K Raja Bhanu, Director-General, Pharmexcil, said the growth was driven by for-

mulations, biologicals, vaccines and AYUSH products. “The Indian pharmaceutical industry is currently valued at \$60 billion and is projected to grow to \$130 billion by 2030,” he added.

Pharmexcil Chairman Namit Joshi said India is likely to end the current financial year at levels similar to FY25. Pharma exports had aggregated to \$30.47 billion in FY25 marking a year-on-year growth of 9.4 per cent.

Referring to the impact of the West Asian crisis, Joshi said that to achieve total exports of \$32 billion in FY26, shipments in March would need to hit \$3.72 billion, based on the exist-

ing export invoices of exporters. However, he noted that the final export figures for FY26 would depend on the volume registered in March.

Rajesh Agarwal, Secretary, Department of Commerce, said the pharmaceutical industry should reduce its critical dependence on imports used in the manufacturing process, while insulating exports from global geopolitical uncertainties.

Though a 100 per cent import substitution may not be feasible, particularly in areas such as active pharmaceutical ingredients and other key raw materials. “...it should be pursued to the maximum possible extent,” he added.

Eyeing 10,000 EVs, global push: Switch Mobility CEO

bl.interview

Amit Vijay Mohile
Mumbai

Switch Mobility, the electric vehicle arm of Ashok Leyland, is targeting a doubling of its fleet to around 10,000 vehicles over the next two years, as it scales up global operations and transitions towards a more self-sustained operating model.

A key pillar of its next phase of growth is international expansion, anchored by a new manufacturing plant in Ras Al Khaimah (the UAE) that has the total capacity of up to 10,000 buses annually for the overall group and serve markets across the GCC, Africa and Europe.

Analysts say Switch has entered a new phase, having achieved EBITDA and PAT breakeven in FY26 and is now moving towards self-sustained growth, with parent Ashok Leyland expected to take a more calibrated approach to capital allocation after investing over ₹1,200 crore.

In a conversation with

In this business, the sale is just the beginning. We are managing a long lifecycle

GANESH MANI
CEO of Switch Mobility



businessline, Ganesh Mani, CEO of Switch Mobility, spoke about growth, global strategy and the shift from a sales-led to an operations-led EV business and also factors in the rising cost pressures from batteries, commodities and supply chain disruptions which the auto industry and electric bus OEMs are facing.

Edited Excerpts:

Switch has scaled sharply. What is the next milestone?
We have grown from around 444 buses last year to over 1,200 this year. Overall, we now have more than 5,000 vehicles on the road, with a 23 per cent market share in electric buses and over 40

per cent in LCVs in the 2-3.5 tonne category. From here, our ambition is to double.

Our larger goal is to move towards around 10,000 vehicles over the next two years... That is the broad direction we are working on depending on how the market evolves.

You’ve begun exports. What scale are you seeing internationally?
We have already exported about 100 buses to Mauritius. We have a further pipeline of around 100 units across markets such as Seychelles, Bhutan and Nepal. These are evolving markets, and volumes will build gradually.

How does the UAE

facility shape your global strategy?
The Ras Al Khaimah facility will cater to GCC, Africa, and European markets, helping us be closer to customers and improve cost efficiency. It also helps us diversify beyond India and reduce dependence on a single market.

The majority of your bus contracts are on a GCC (gross cost contract) basis and have a 12-year operating model. What changes in execution?
In this business, the sale is just the beginning. We are managing a long lifecycle. All our vehicles are connected and monitored through a central command centre, processing around 12 million data points annually. This allows us to maintain about 98 per cent uptime, which builds customer confidence.

Costs across the industry are said to be rising 20-30%. How are you seeing this?
There are multiple pressures — battery costs, commodity prices such as steel,

foreign exchange movements and supply chain disruptions.

These challenges affect the entire industry, and EVs are more sensitive. We are working on internal efficiencies, but these factors will have to be considered while bidding for new tenders.

What is your capex plan for FY27, especially given Ashok Leyland has already invested over ₹1,200 crore in the business?
We are currently self-sufficient and able to manage our growth with the existing business. As we expand into new products and markets, we will evaluate capital requirements, but at this stage, we are able to sustain our growth.

As COO of Ashok Leyland, what is the outlook for FY27?
FY26 was a strong year for us. For FY27, the industry is undergoing a phase of recalibration, so we cannot comment on it at this time. Our focus remains on staying agile and executing well in a dynamic environment.

India resumes energy trade with Iran after 7 years; gets LPG cargo

Our Bureau
New Delhi

The Ministry of Petroleum and Natural Gas said on Saturday that Indian refiners have sourced crude oil from Iran, marking the first such purchase from the Persian Gulf nation after May 2019.

The development comes after the US un-sanctioned Iranian crude oil as the intensifying West Asian conflict prolonging the closure of the Strait of Hormuz has choked 20 per cent of the global supplies.

AVLGC (very large gas carrier) also delivered 44,000 tonnes of Iranian liquefied petroleum gas (LPG) to India on Thursday.

Refuting news reports and social media posts on an Iranian crude cargo diverted from Vadinar to China due to payment issues, the Ministry reiterated that India’s crude oil requirements for the coming months remain fully se-

cured. India imports crude oil from more than 40 countries, with companies having full flexibility to source oil from different sources and geographies based on commercial considerations, Oil Ministry emphasised.

NO PAYMENT ISSUE
“Amid Middle East supply disruptions, Indian refiners have secured their crude oil requirements, including from Iran, and there is no payment hurdle for Iranian crude imports, contrary to the rumours being circulated,” it added.

Claims on vessel diversion ignore how the oil trade works. Bills of Lading often carry indicative discharge port destinations and cargoes can change destinations mid-voyage based on trade optimisation and operational flexibility, it explained.

“On LPG, too, some claims being made are incorrect as LPG vessel Sea Bird carrying around 44,000 tonnes Iranian

LPG berthed at Mangalore on April 2 and is currently discharging,” the Ministry added.

India utilises the rupee payment mechanism between UCO Bank and Iran’s non-sanctioned banks having Vostro accounts with the former for payments. This was done after US and EU sanctions restricted dollar-based transactions.

India stopped buying crude oil from Iran after sanctions were re-imposed on the country by the US in November 2018 giving India six-months to wind down imports. Iran was India’s No 3 crude supplier in 2017, accounting for 12-13 per cent of the total imports. At one point, Tehran was supplying more than 425,000 barrels per day (b/d) to New Delhi.

Sanctions imposed by the US in 2011 and the EU in 2012 displaced more than 1 million barrels per day (mb/d) of Iranian crude on the global market, as per the US EIA.

BJP releases white paper on ‘financial crisis’ in TN



BJP’s Tamil Nadu election in-charge Piyush Goyal (right) and State BJP President Nainar Nagendran release a white paper on ‘TN Government Financial Crisis’ brought out by the State BJP Professional Cell, in Chennai **BUJOY GHOSH**

Our Bureau
Chennai

The Tamil Nadu BJP’s Professional Cell has released a white paper with details of what it calls a ‘financial crisis’ in Tamil Nadu under the incumbent DMK government, highlighting the State’s increasing revenue deficit and debt.

OUTSTANDING DEBT
The report stated that Tamil Nadu’s revenue deficit of ₹69,129 crore as of FY26 stood at 1.94 per cent of Gross State Domestic Product (GSDP) and that the State’s outstanding debt had reached ₹8.34 lakh crore by March 2024, projected to hit ₹10.71 lakh crore by March 2027.

It added that interest payments have surged from ₹36,215 crore in FY23 to ₹76,451 crore FY27. The government has also incurred

hidden liabilities through PSUs such as TANGEDCO, which obscure the fiscal picture, the report said.

Titled ‘Tamil Nadu Government Financial Crisis,’ the white paper was released here on Saturday at a press conference by the party’s State in-charge for the 2026 Tamil Nadu Assembly election and Union Commerce Minister Piyush Goyal, who was joined by other senior BJP leaders from the State.

Speaking at the press conference, Goyal said that the DMK government and the CM’s family are using the State as an ATM instead of addressing the financial issues in the State.

“The Centre has given Tamil Nadu over ₹80,000 crore to the State in GST collections. They have to answer to the people where all this money has gone. This is one of the most irresponsible State governments in the country,” he said.

PMK chief flags TN’s debt surge in DMK rule; calls for change

T E Raja Simhan
Chennai

Tamil Nadu needs a change after five years of Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) rule, Anbumani Ramadoss, President of the Pattali Makkal Katchi (PMK), said on Saturday, urging voters to “give an opportunity” to the opposition alliance in the upcoming polls.

The PMK is part of the All India Anna Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (AIADMK)-led alliance and proposes what it calls an alternative model of governance. “We are going to the people asking for one chance. Give us an opportunity and we will provide good administration,” he told journalists of *The Hindu* group during an interaction.

Ramadoss alleged that the DMK had failed to deliver on its 2021 election promises. Of the 505 assurances made, only a small set had been fully implemented, he claimed. “The AIADMK will win the elections comfortably as there is a strong anti-



incumbency given the concerns over governance, law and order, welfare delivery, and the State’s financial health,” he said.

The PMK would play a “guiding role” in the alliance to ensure accountability if they came to power, he added.

DEBT CONCERNS
Ramadoss flagged the State’s rising debt as a key concern. He alleged that the State’s total liabilities have nearly doubled in the past five years to around ₹10 lakh crore. According to him, all of Tamil Nadu’s ruling governments since Independence had together accumulated about ₹4.5 lakh crore in debt, but the DMK had added nearly

₹5 lakh crore just during its current regime. He claimed that only a limited share of borrowings had gone into capital expenditure, with a significant portion used for servicing existing loans and meeting routine expenses. “Borrowing for asset creation is acceptable, but borrowing to run day-to-day administration is not sustainable,” he said. Anbumani Ramadoss also raised concerns over the State’s liquor policy and operations of the Tamil Nadu State Marketing Corporation. He claimed that thousands of unauthorised outlets operate alongside official TASMAC shops and accused the government of failing to curb leakage and corruption.

businessline.

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